



School of Computer Science and Engineering

Trustworthy Systems Group

Formalising device protocols for sDDF driver verification

Liam Murphy

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Background

Why Drivers?



- Drivers are a frequent source of OS bugs
 - Majority of Linux CVEs from 2018–2022

Why Drivers?

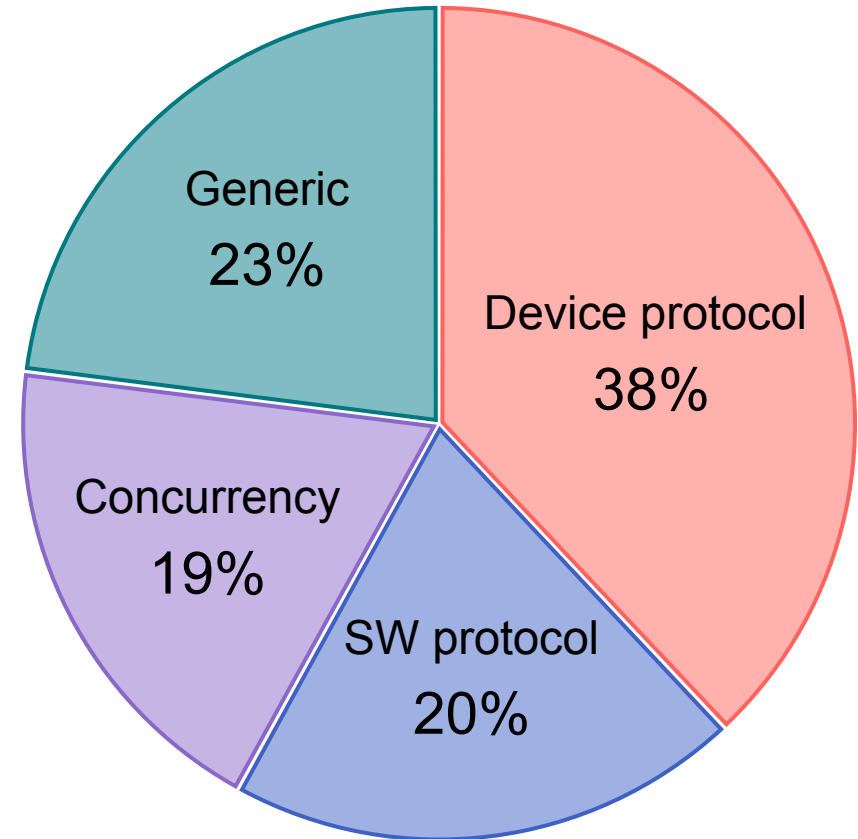


- Drivers are a frequent source of OS bugs
 - Majority of Linux CVEs from 2018–2022
- Formal methods are the only reliable way to prevent this

Why Drivers?



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 - Majority of Linux CVEs from 2018–2022
- Formal methods are the only reliable way to prevent this
- Dominant cause is device-protocol violations

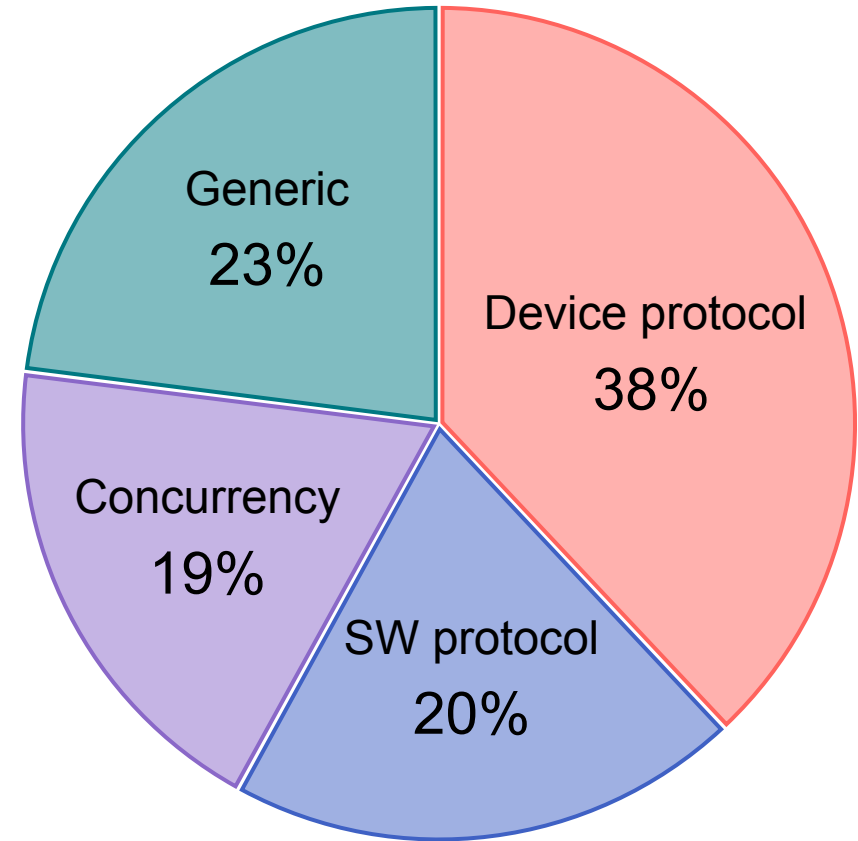


Causes of Linux driver bugs, 2002–2008
[Ryzhyk et al. 2009]

Why Drivers?

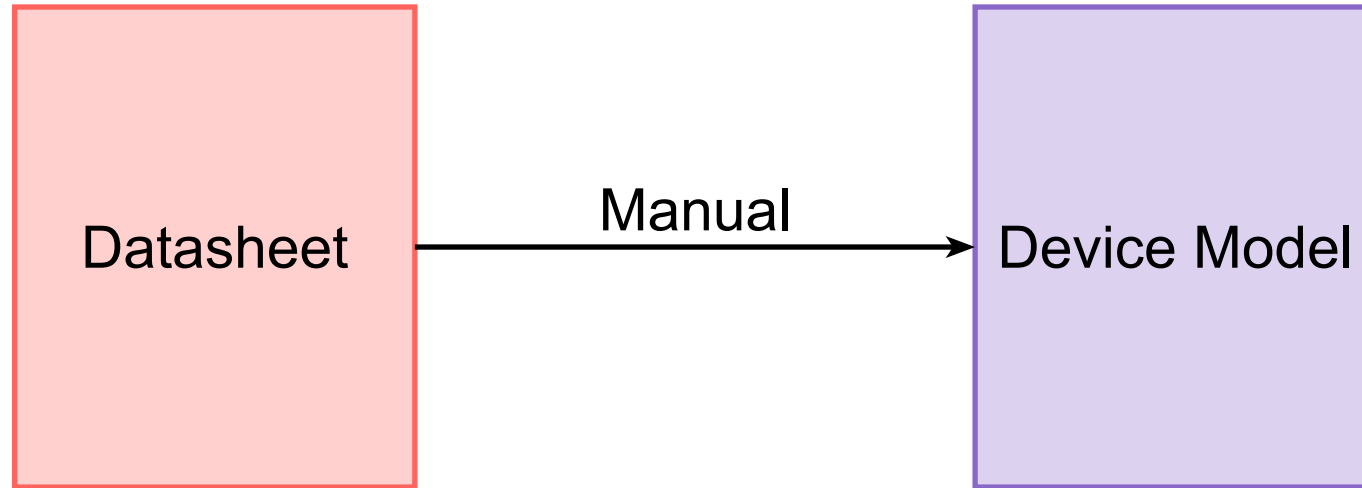


- Drivers are a frequent source of OS bugs
 - Majority of Linux CVEs from 2018–2022
- Formal methods are the only reliable way to prevent this
- Dominant cause is device-protocol violations
 - Without a formal model of the protocol, formal methods cannot prevent this

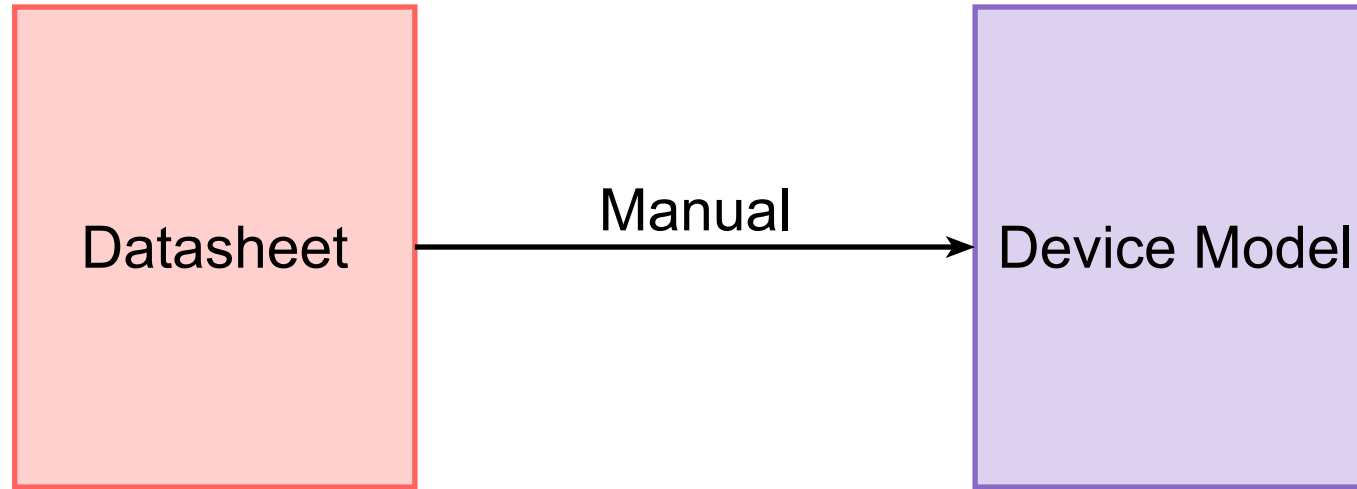


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Datasheets

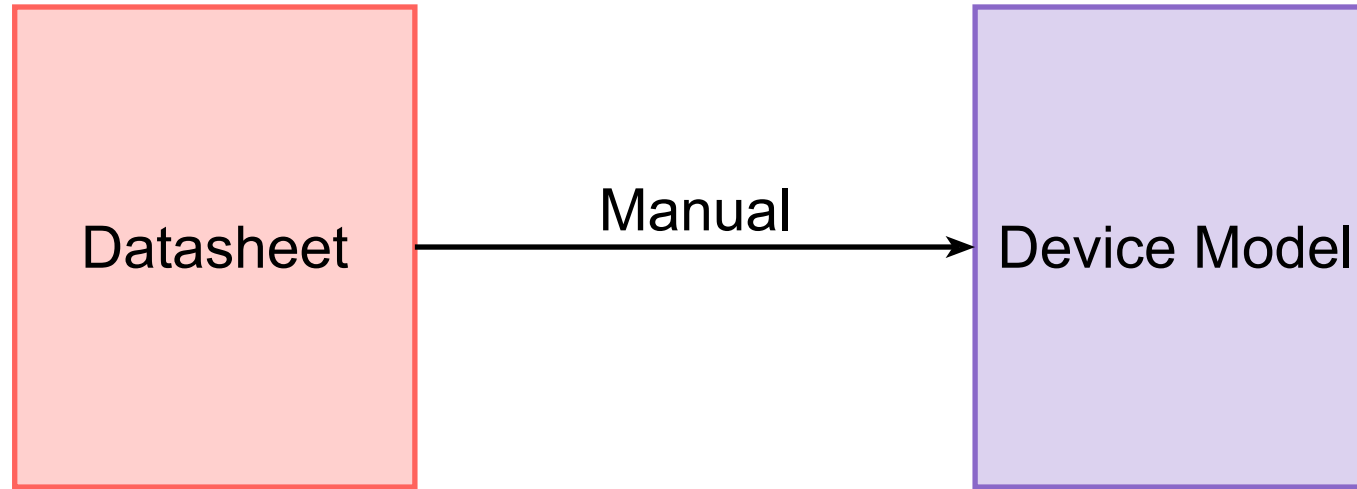


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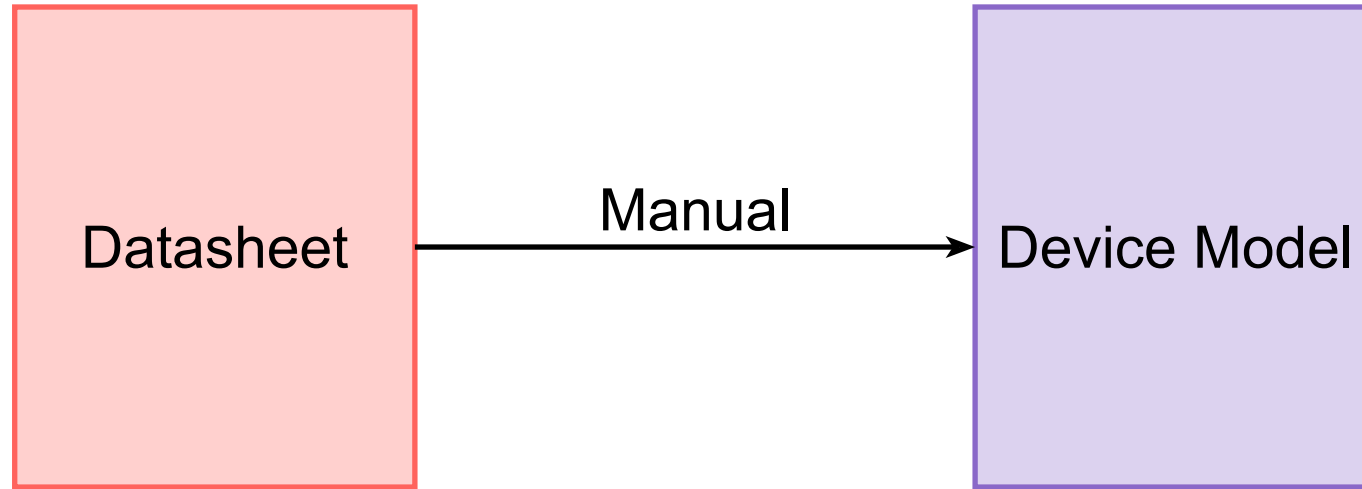
- Imprecise

Datasheets



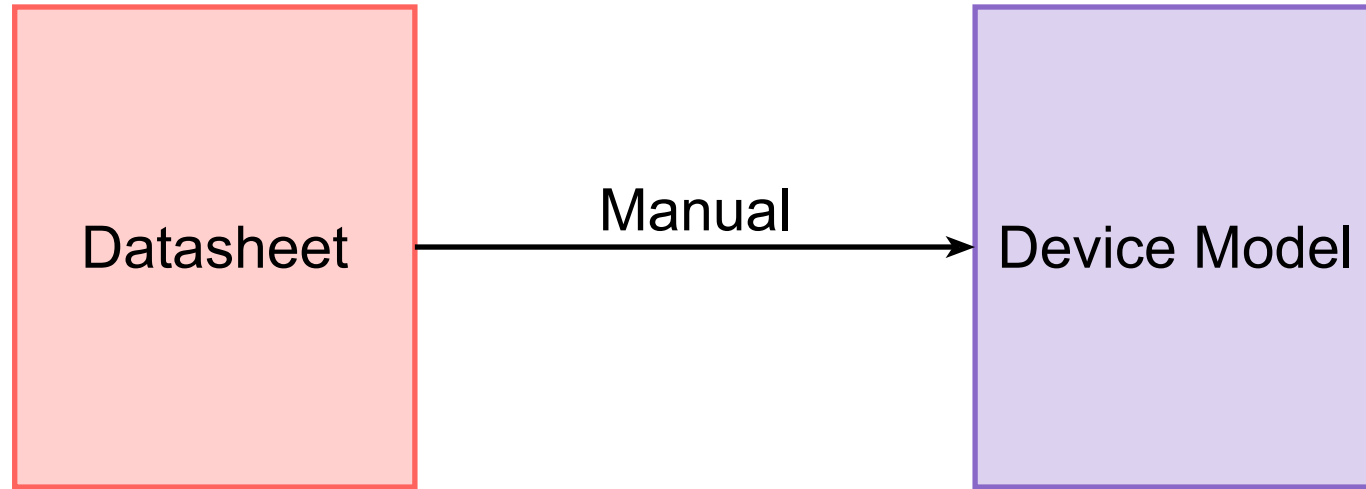
- Imprecise
- Incomplete

Datasheets



- Imprecise
- Incomplete
- Incorrect?

Datasheets

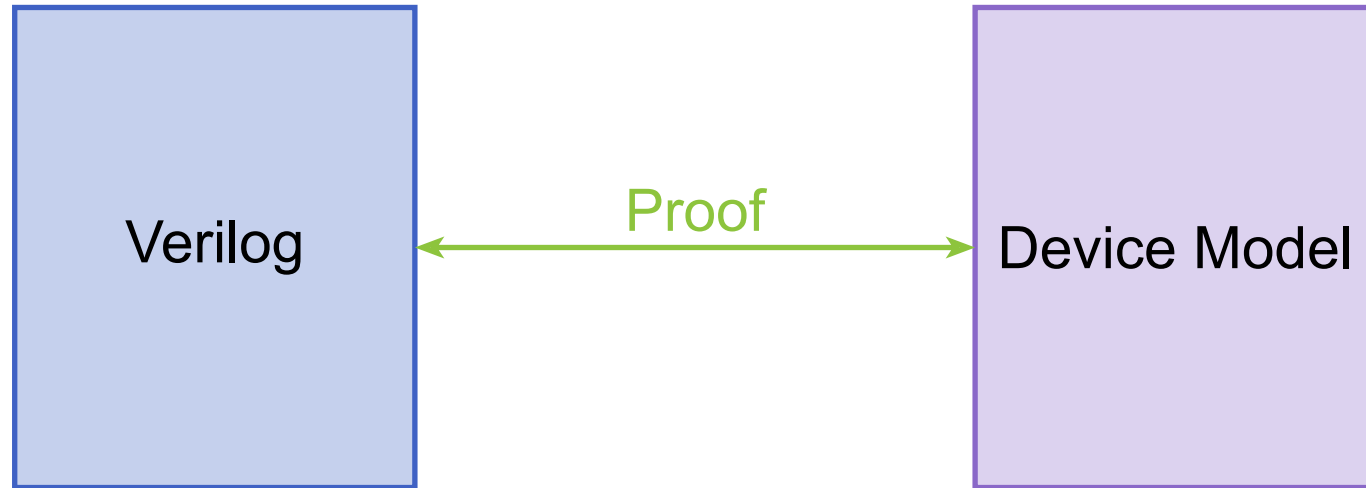


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- Incorrect?



Unreliable!

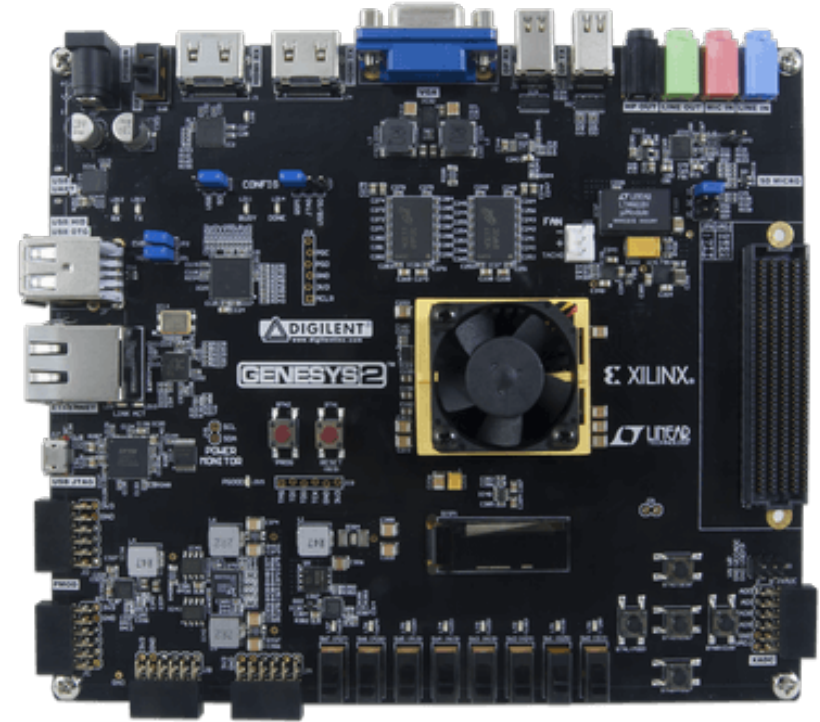
Datasheets



Serengeti



- Fork of Cheshire, an open-source RISC-V SoC from the PULP project
- Runs on common Digilent FPGA dev kits
- Several added features:

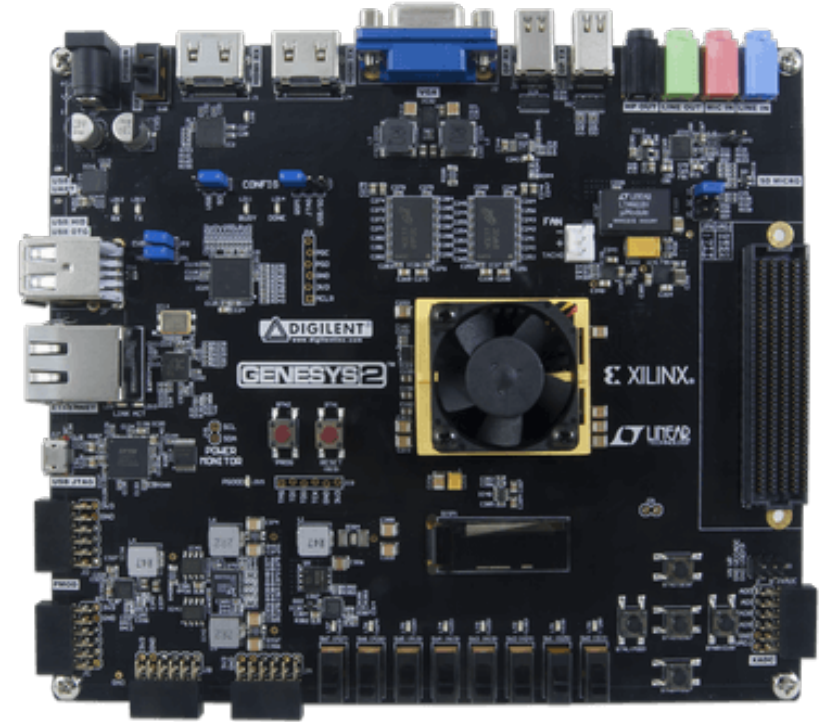


Digilent Genesys2, used to run Serengeti

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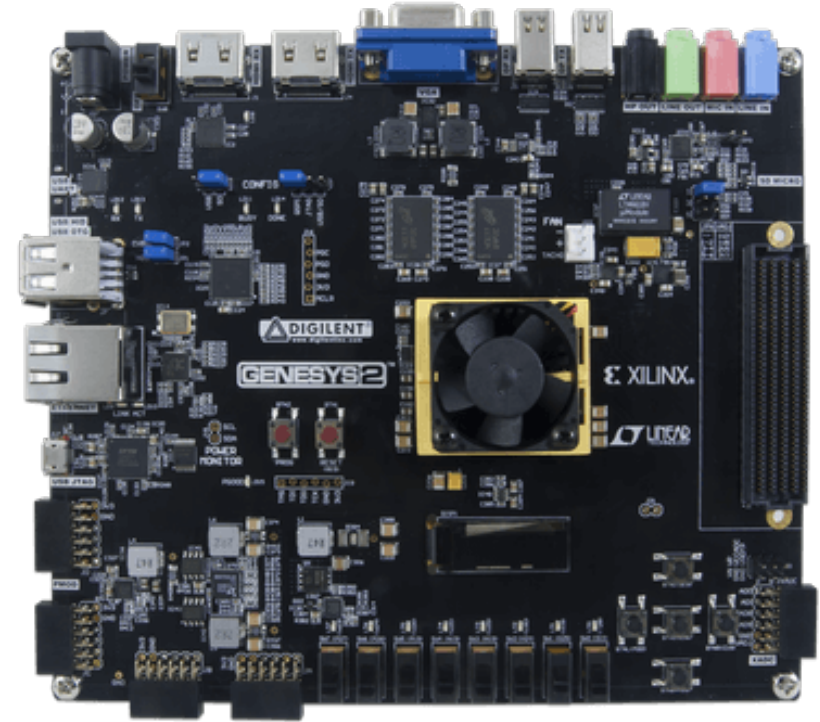


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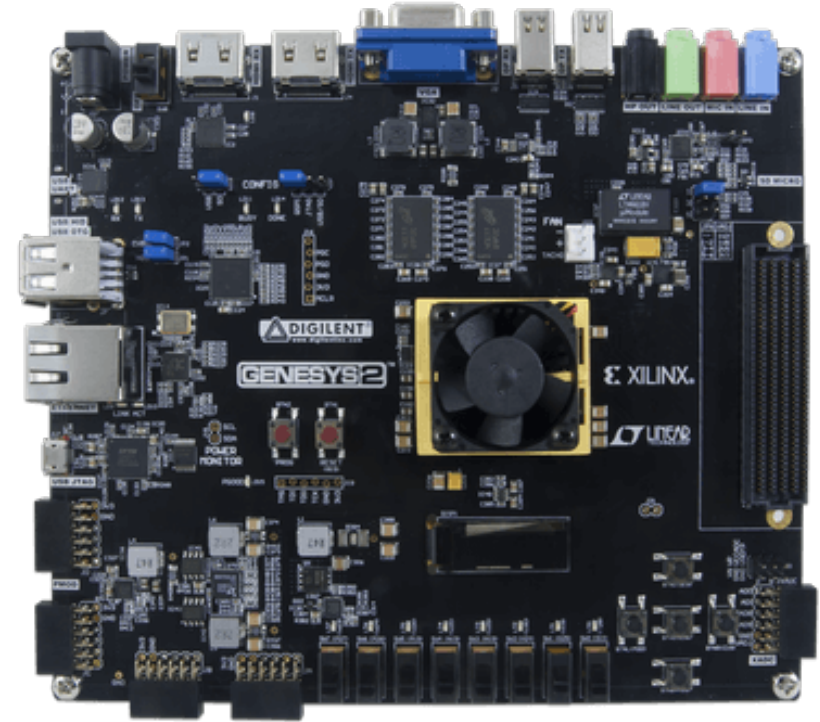


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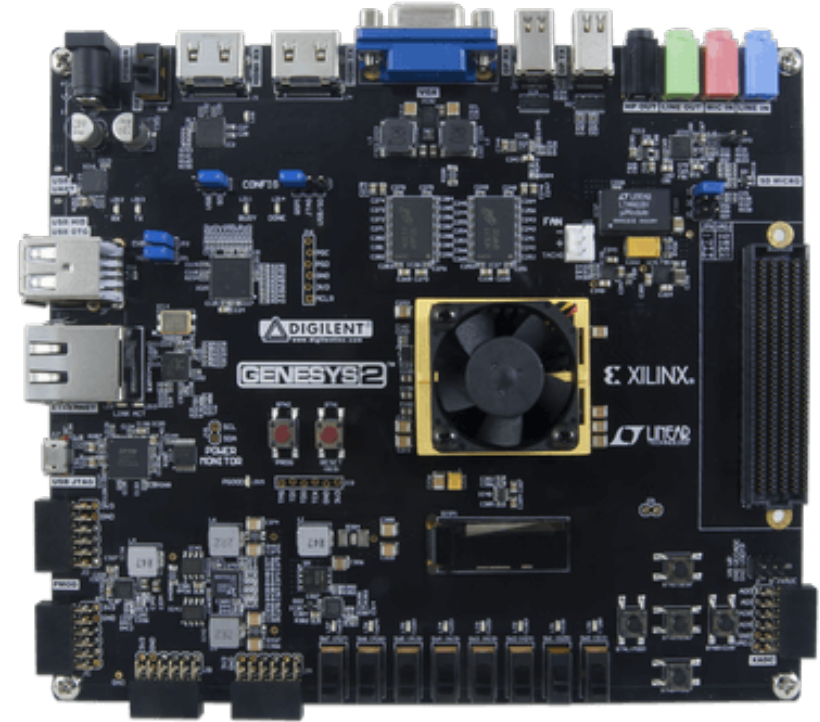


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Serengeti

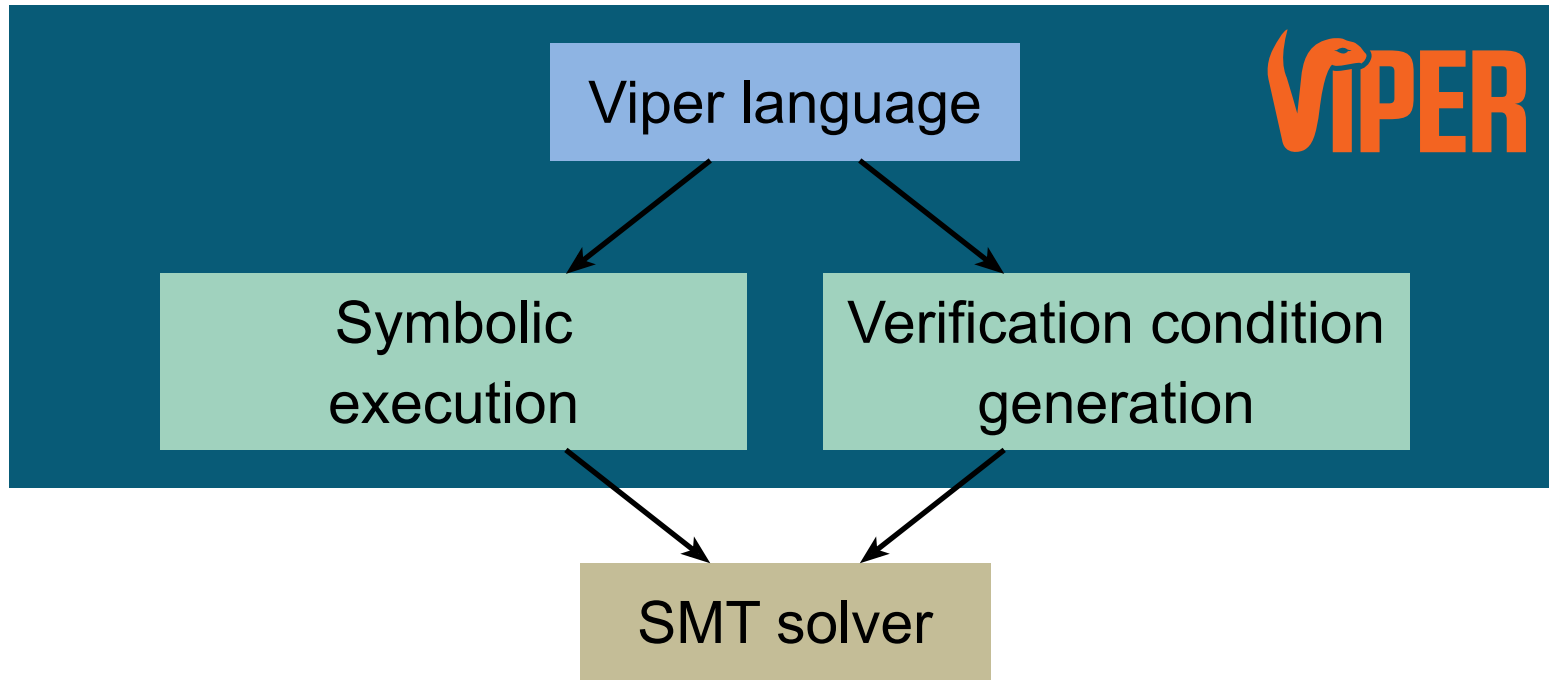


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- Initial target: I²C controller

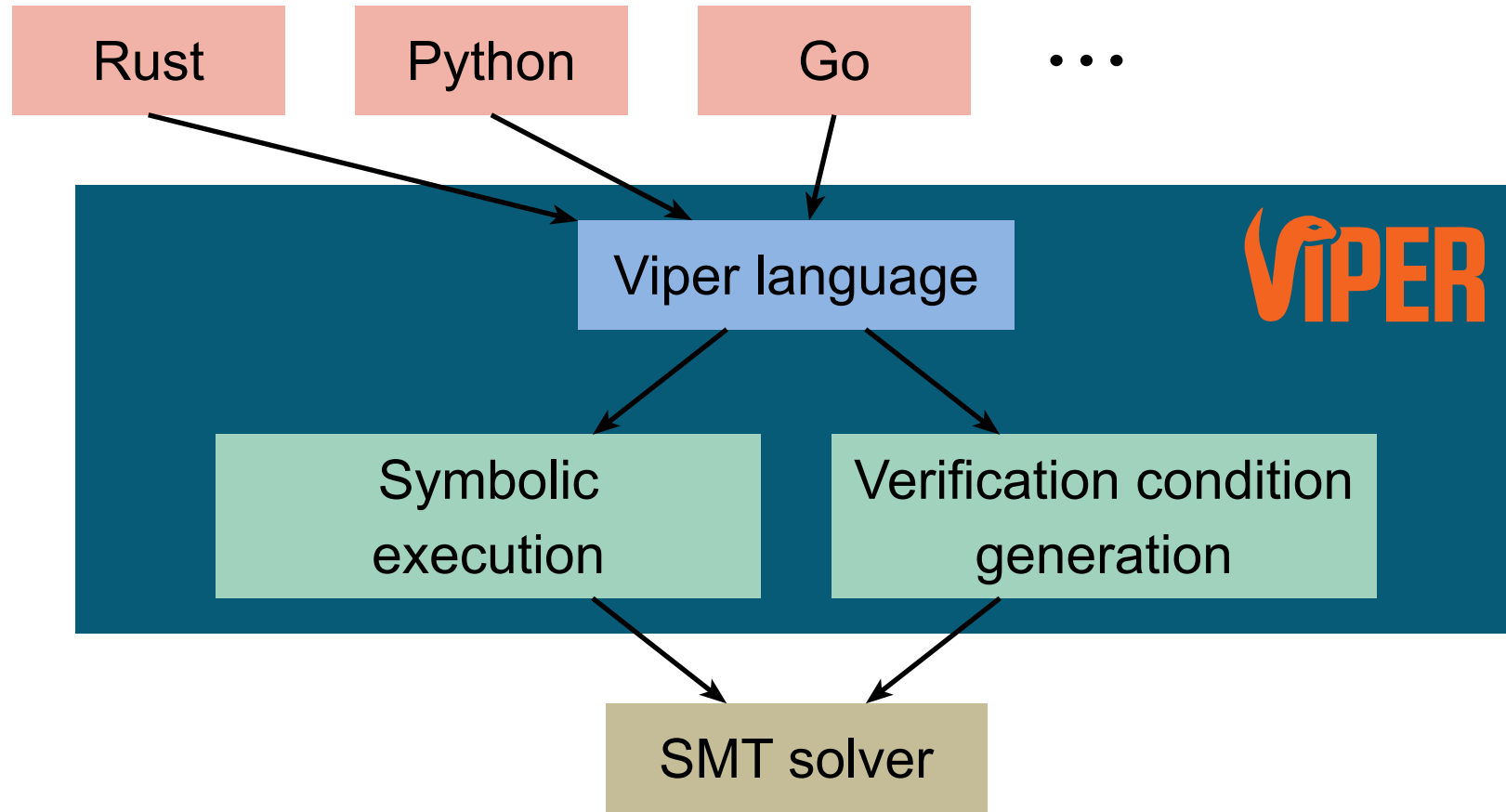


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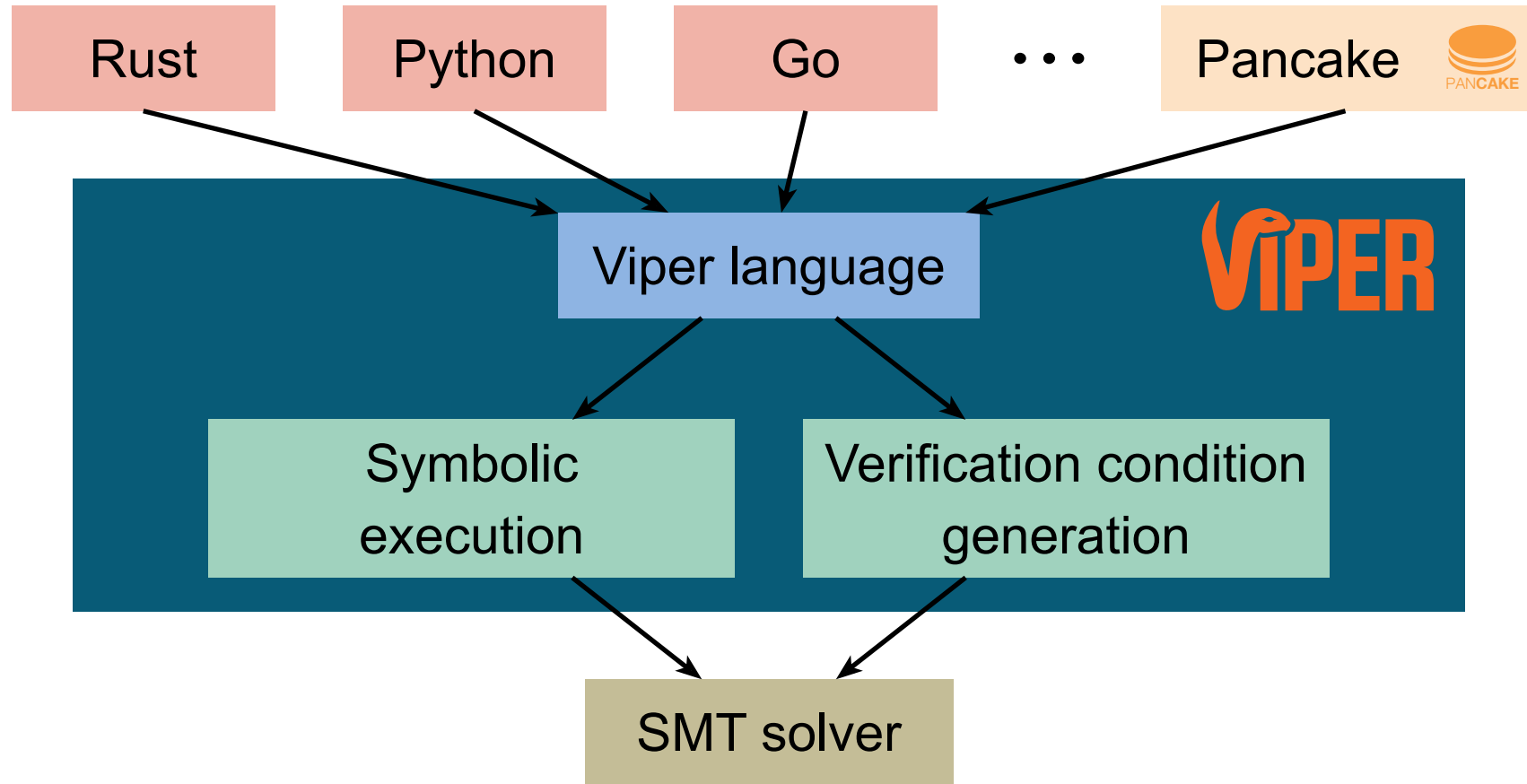
Pancake-to-Viper



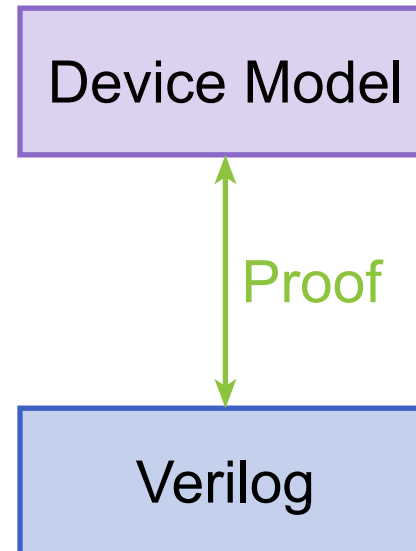
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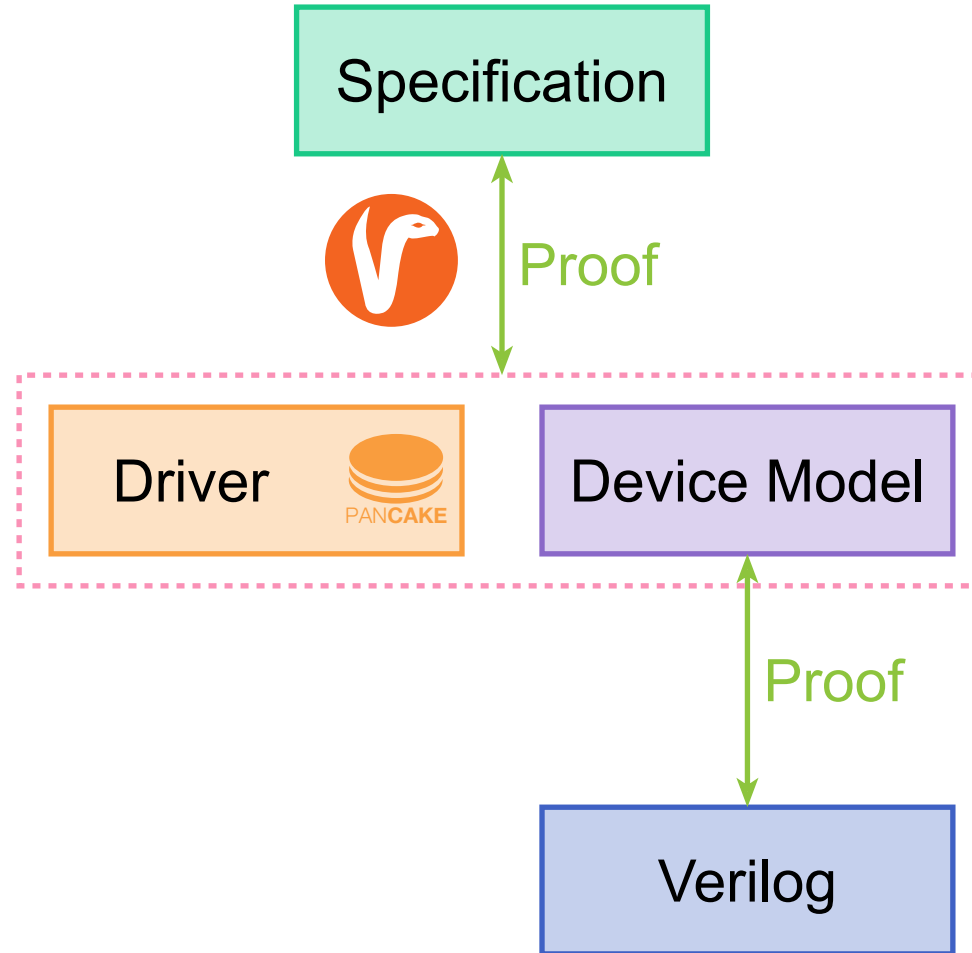
Pancake-to-Viper



Verification Flow



Verification Flow



Overview



- Hardware Verification
- Specification Format
- Driver Verification
- Status
- Future Work

Hardware Verification

Tools



- HOL4 theorem prover
- HOL4 Verilog formalisation (Lööw):

Tools



- HOL4 theorem prover
- HOL4 Verilog formalisation (Lööw):
 - Semantics for Verilog AST

Verilog AST

Tools



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 - Semantics for Verilog AST
 - Semantics for functional representation

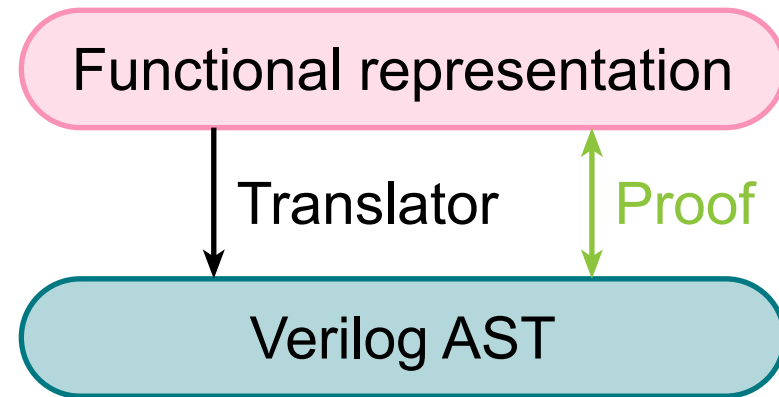
Functional representation

Verilog AST

Tools



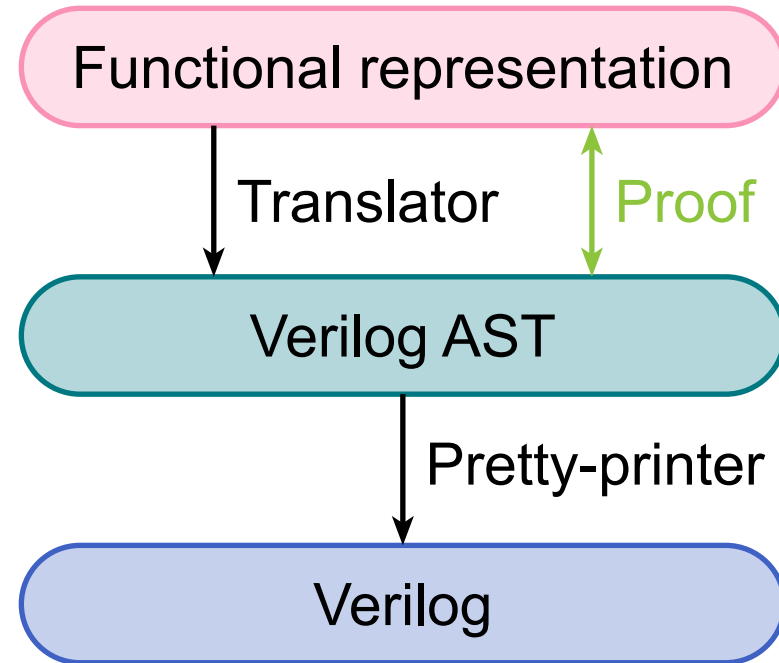
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- HOL4 Verilog formalisation (Lööw):
 - Semantics for Verilog AST
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 - Proof-producing translator from Verilog to AST



Tools



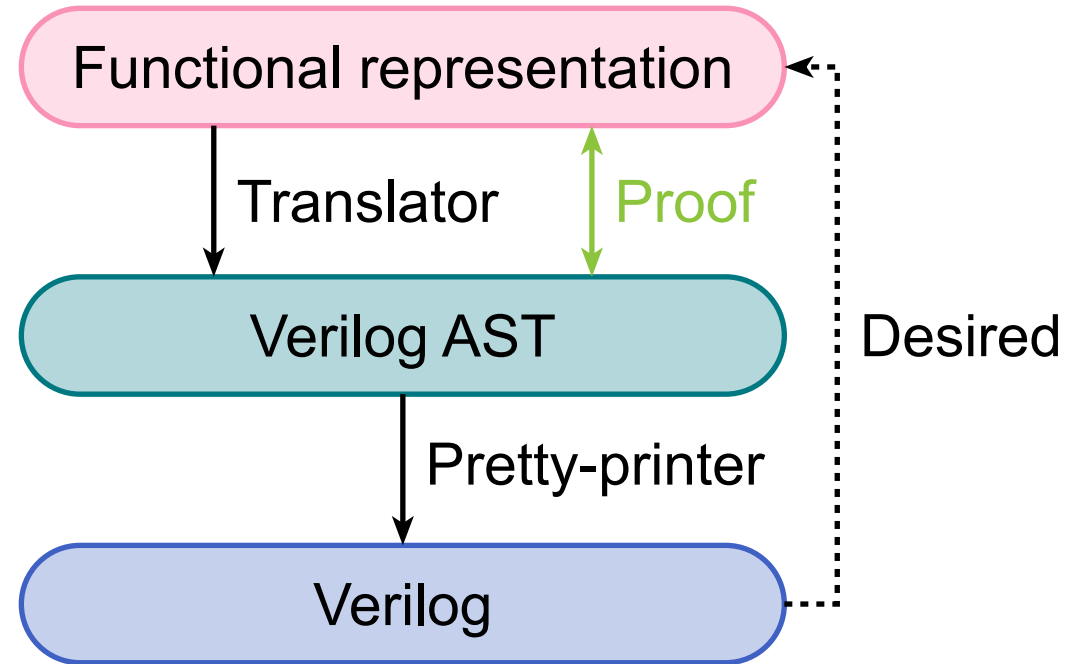
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 - Pretty-printer for deep embedding



Tools



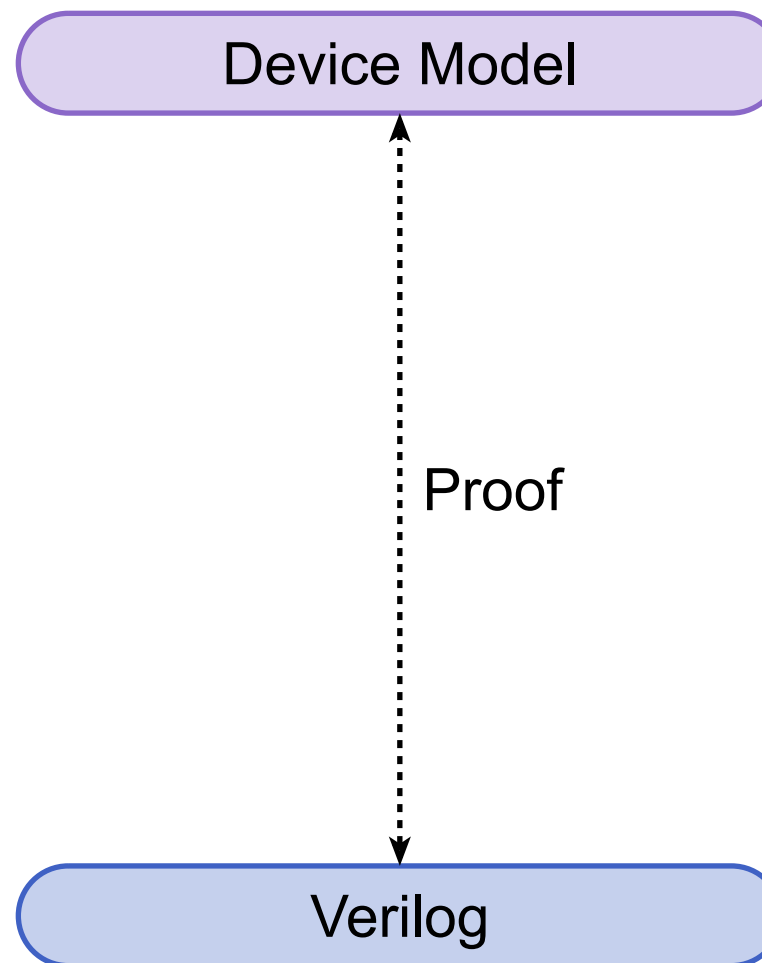
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 - Semantics for functional representation
 - Proof-producing translator from Verilog to AST
 - Pretty-printer for deep embedding
- Problem: need opposite direction



Workflow



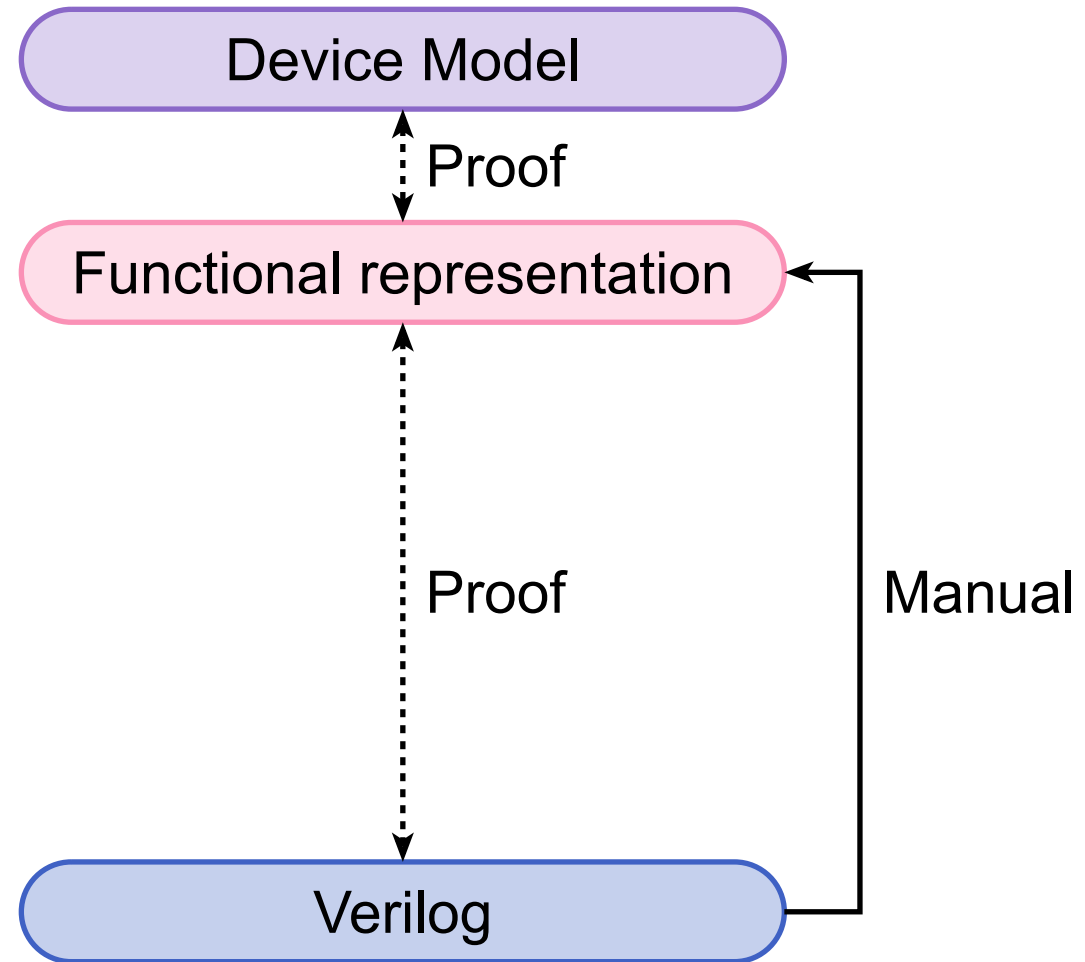
- Workaround:



Workflow



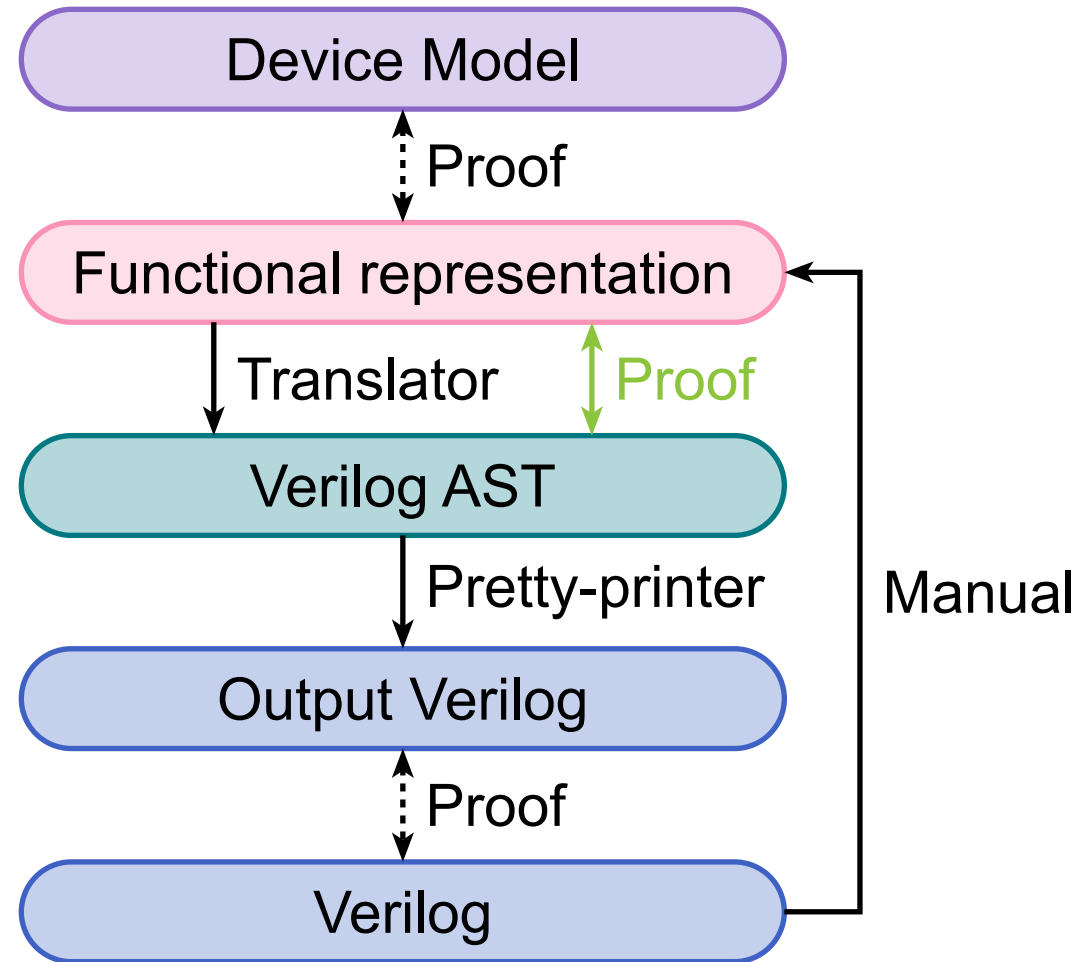
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Workflow



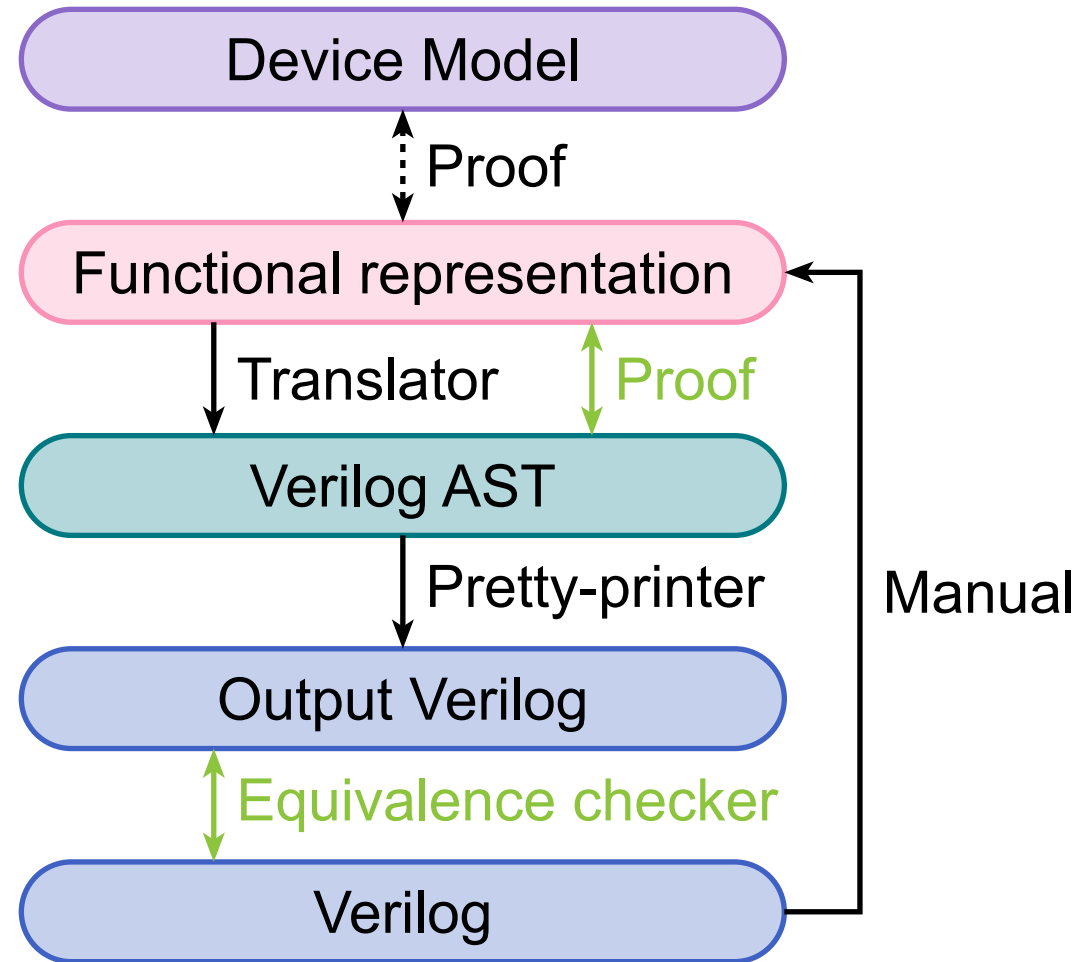
- Workaround:
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 - Translate and export into Verilog



Workflow



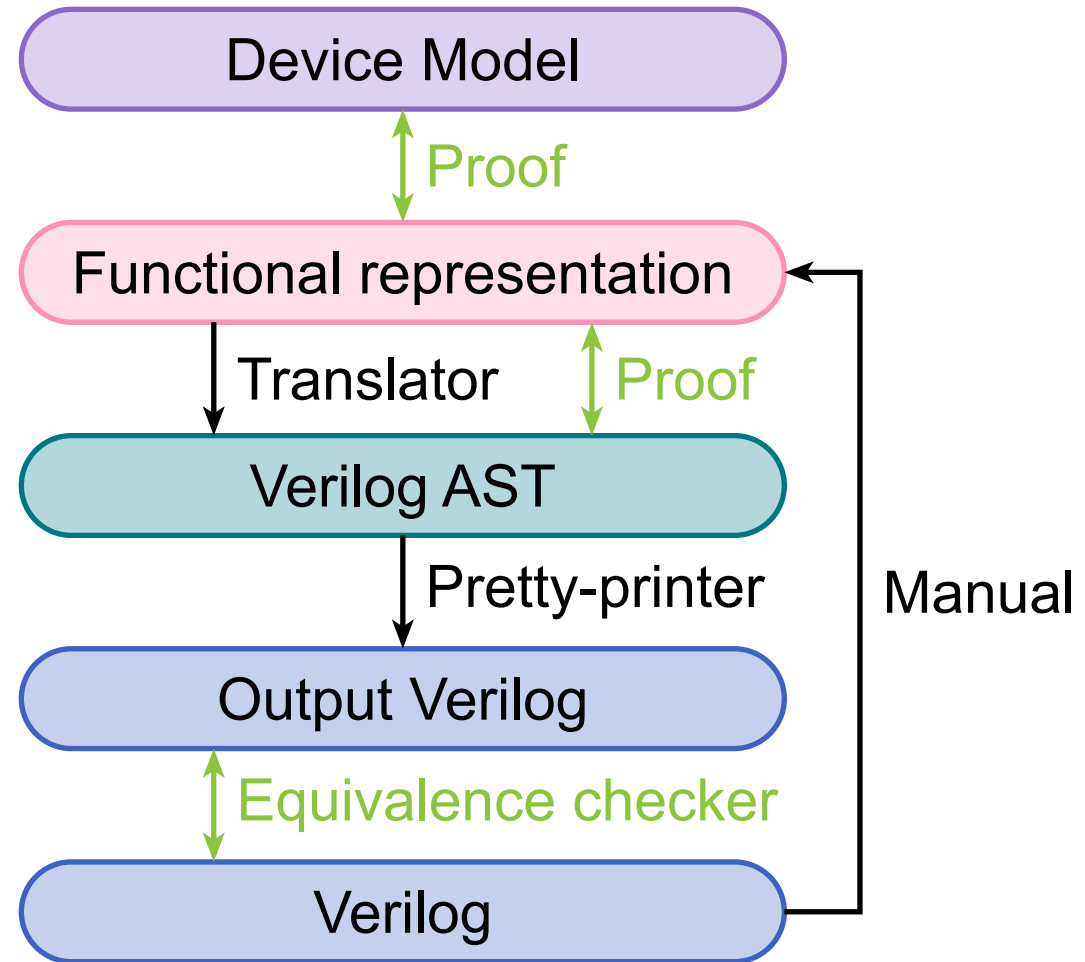
- Workaround:
 - Manually translate Verilog to functional representation
 - Translate and export into Verilog
 - Prove equivalence to original Verilog



Workflow

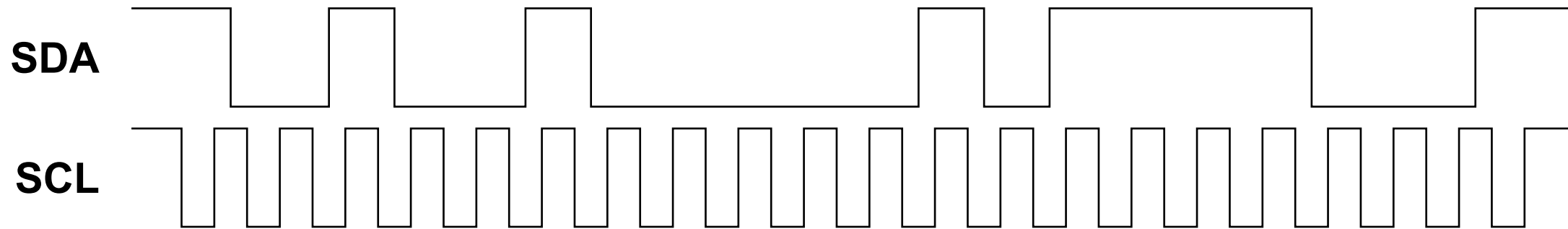


- Workaround:
 - Manually translate Verilog to functional representation
 - Translate and export into Verilog
 - Prove equivalence to original Verilog
- Finally, prove that functional representation refines specification

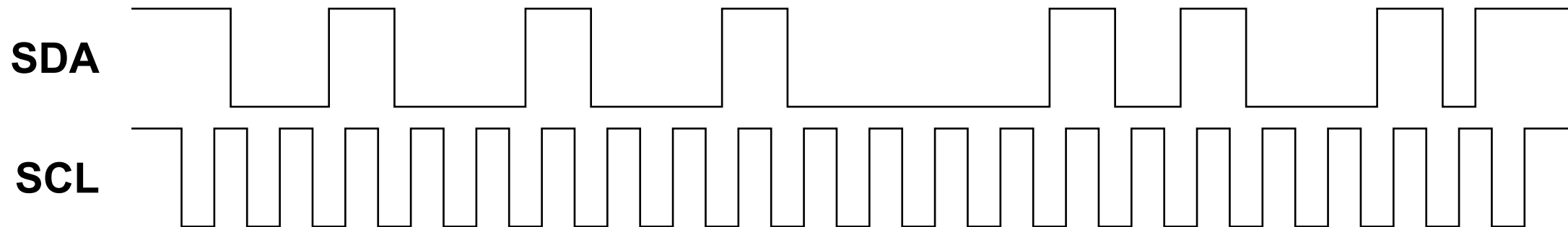


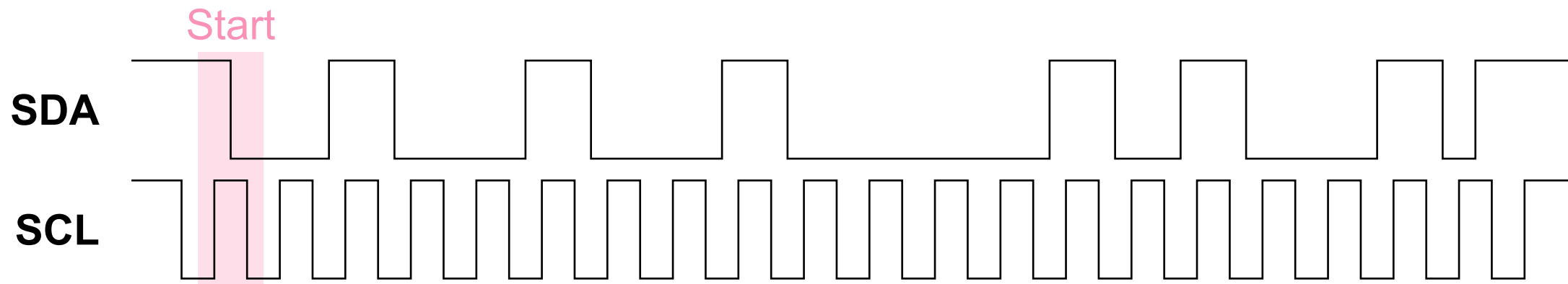
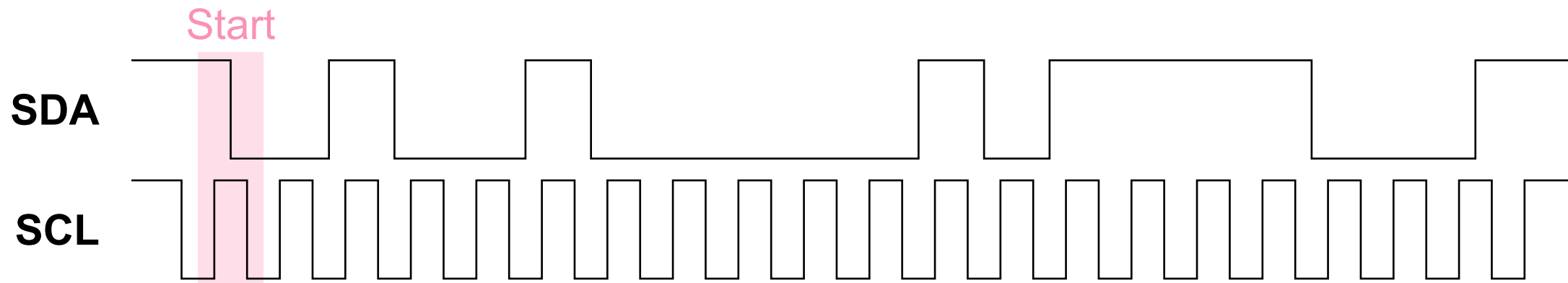
Specification Format

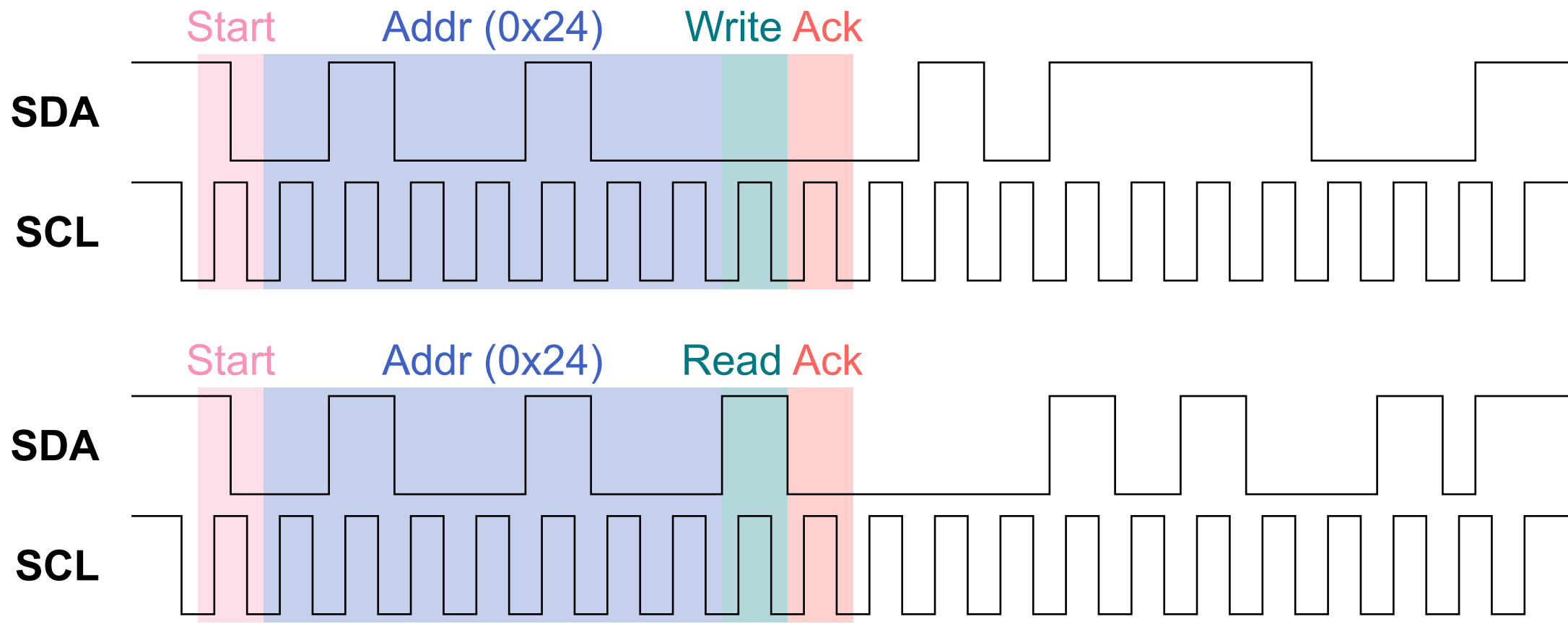
Write

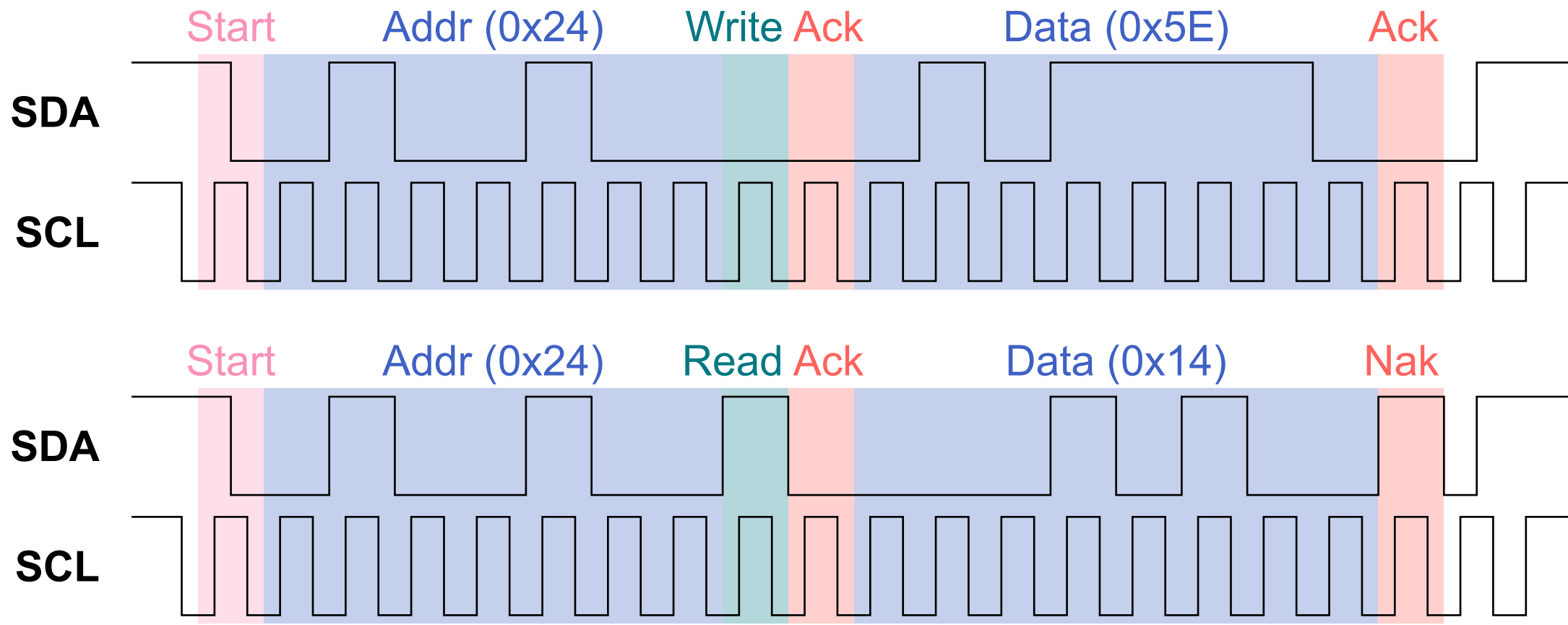


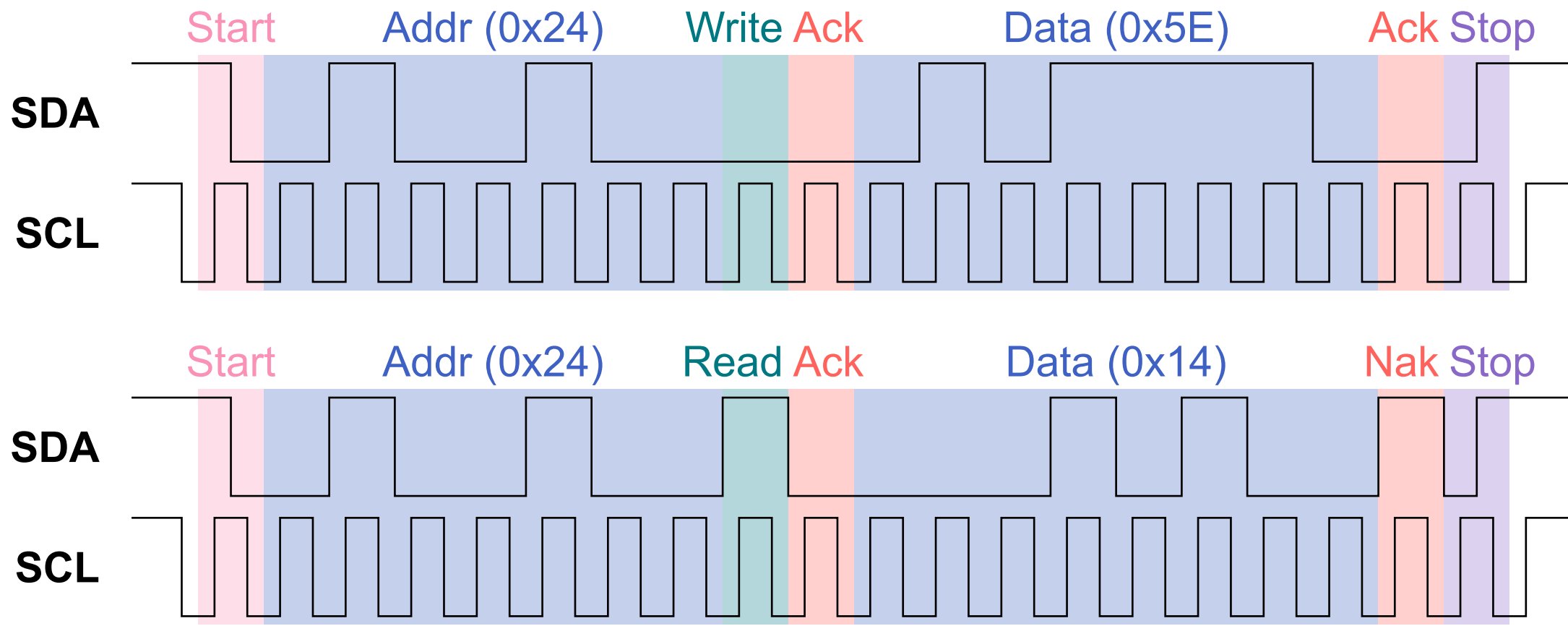
Read











Controller-driven

Start

Addr (0x24)

Write Ack

Data (0x5E)

Ack Stop

SDA

SCL

Start

Addr (0x24)

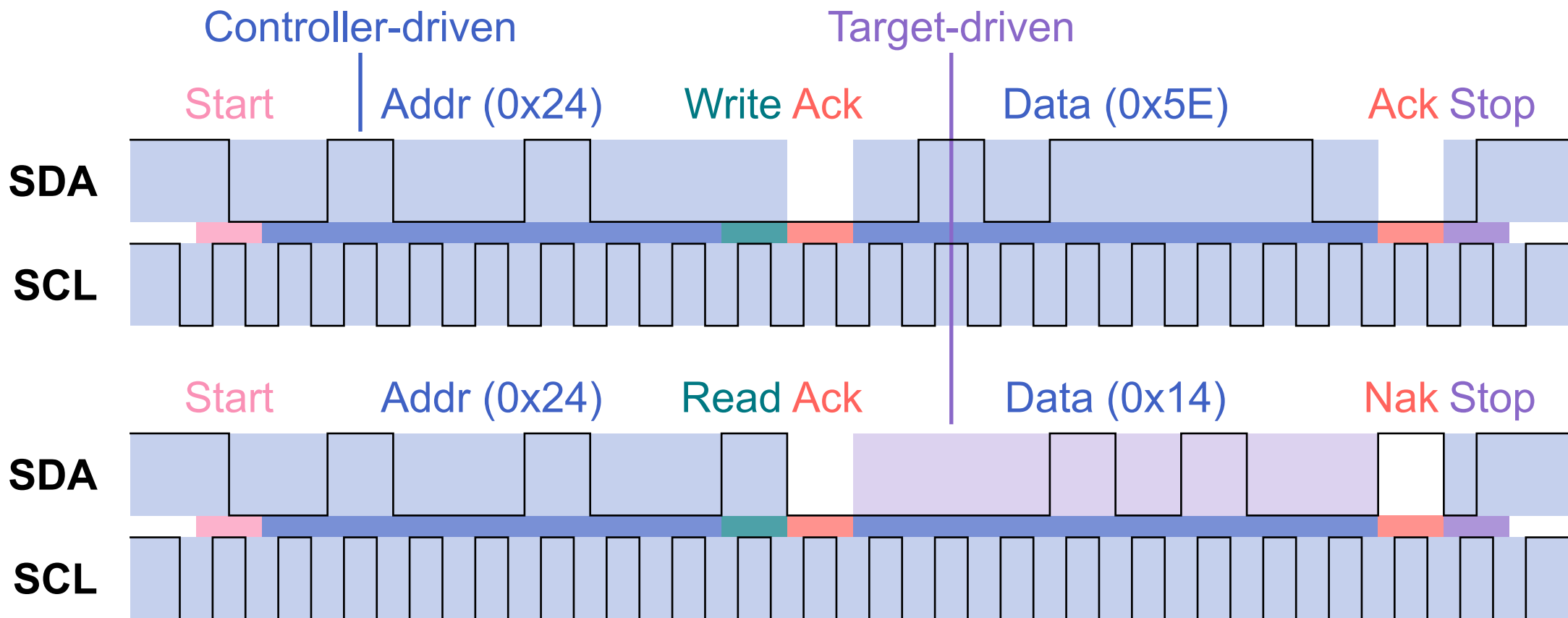
Read Ack

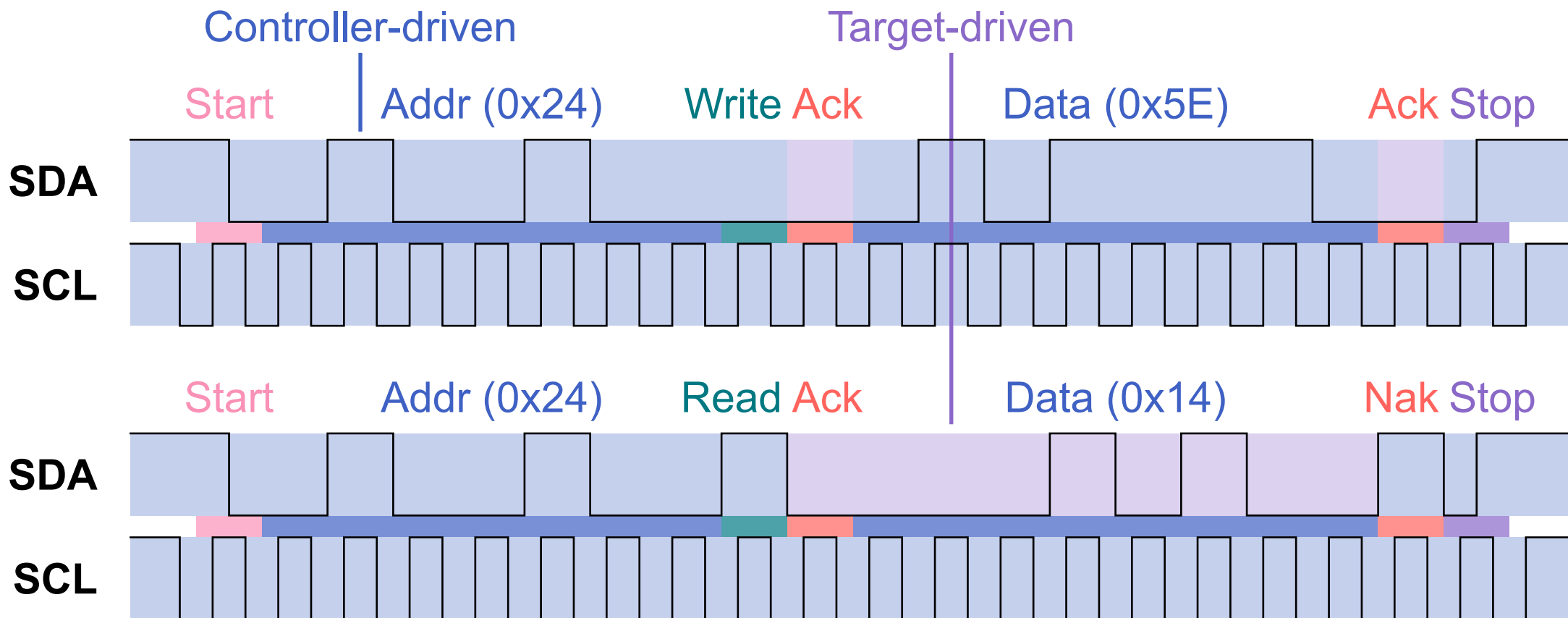
Data (0x14)

Nak Stop

SDA

SCL





OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

false

fmt_fifo

[]

rx_fifo

[]

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

false

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x48 {start}]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ st FDATA $\leftarrow$ Wr 0x48 {start}

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

false

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x48 {start}, Wr 0x5E {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ st FDATA $\leftarrow$ Wr 0x5E {stop}

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x48 {start}, Wr 0x5E {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ st CTRL $\leftarrow$ 1

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

fmt_fifo

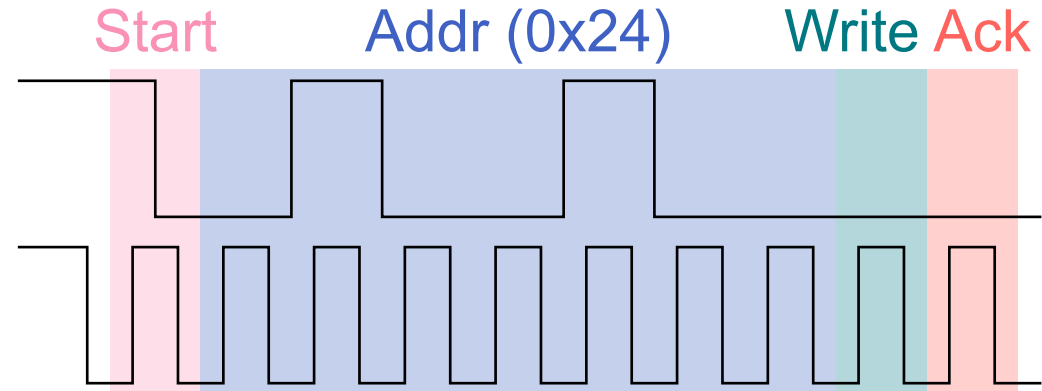
[Wr 0x48 {start}, Wr 0x5E {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]

SDA

SCL



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

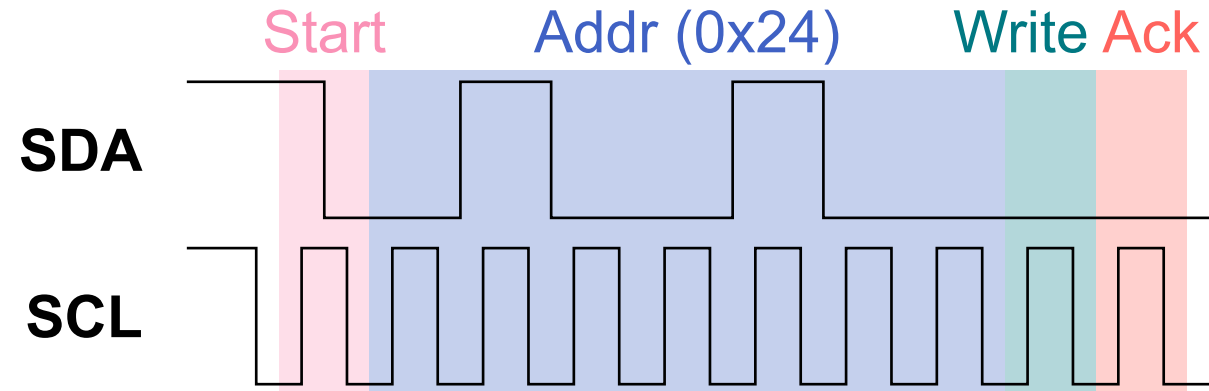
true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x5E {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

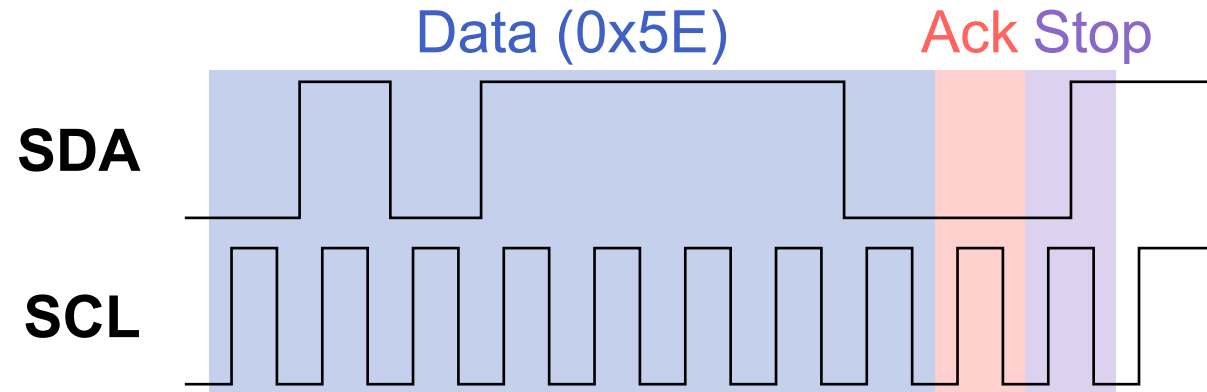
true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x5E {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

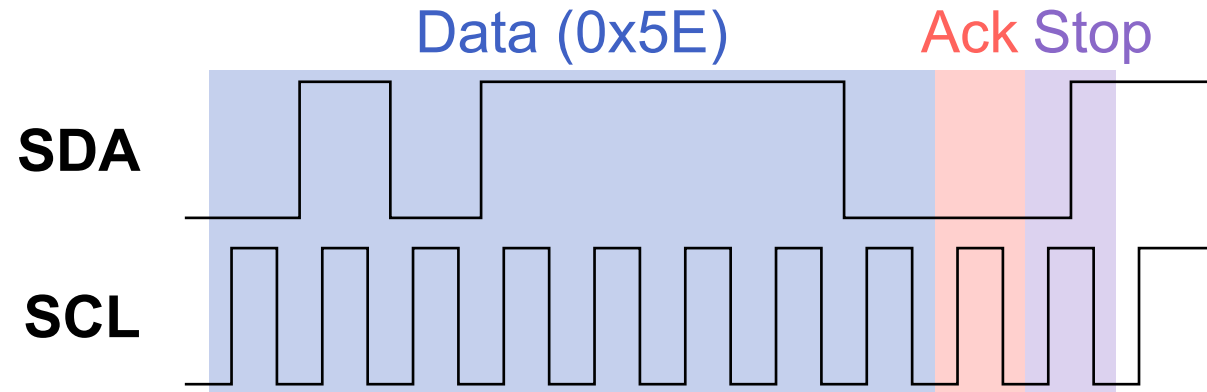
fmt_fifo

[]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ Interrupt!



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x49 {start}]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ st FDATA $\leftarrow$ Wr 0x49 {start}

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x49 {start}, Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]

⚡ st FDATA $\leftarrow$ Rd 3 {stop}

OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

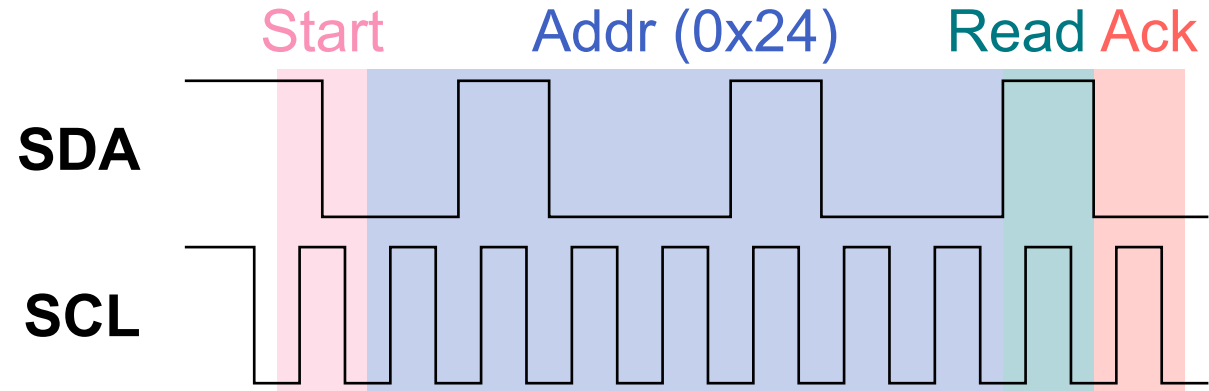
true

fmt_fifo

[Wr 0x49 {start}, Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

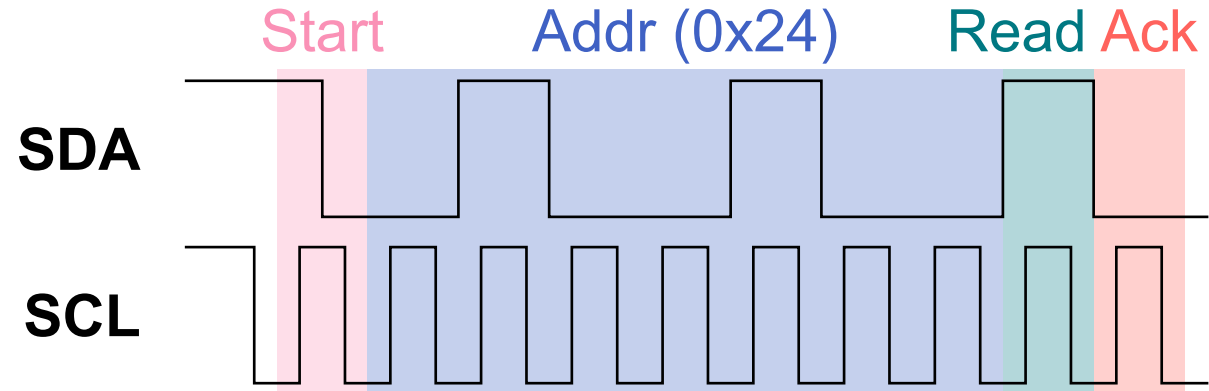
true

fmt_fifo

[Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

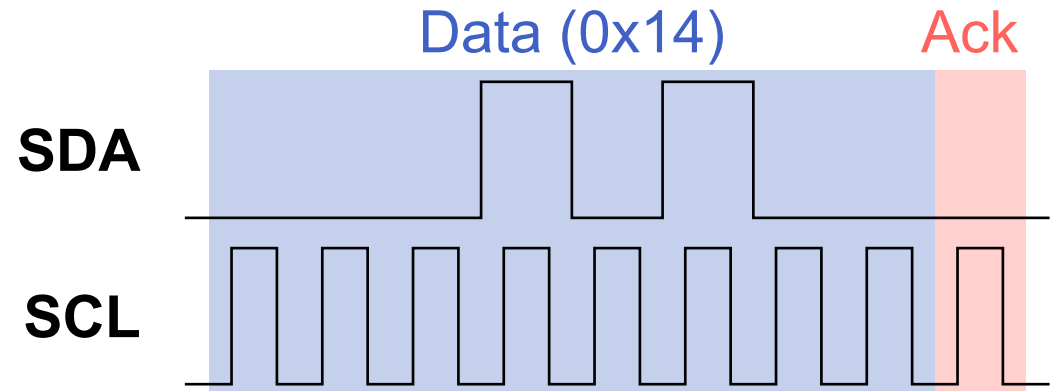
fmt_fifo

[Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[0x14]

⚡ Interrupt!



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

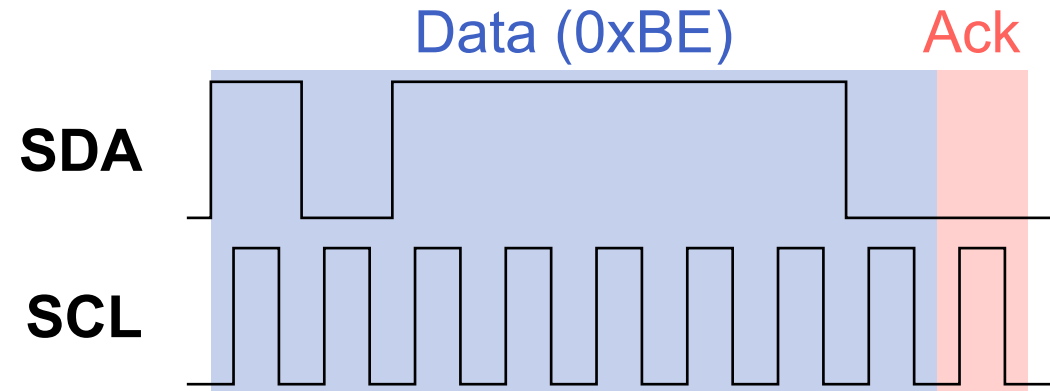
true

fmt_fifo

[Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[0x14, 0xBE]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

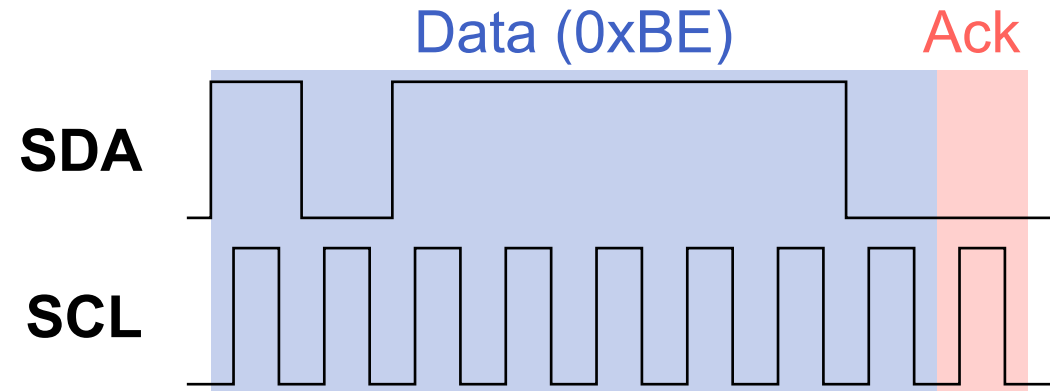
fmt_fifo

[Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[0xBE]

⚡ Id RDATA → 0x14



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

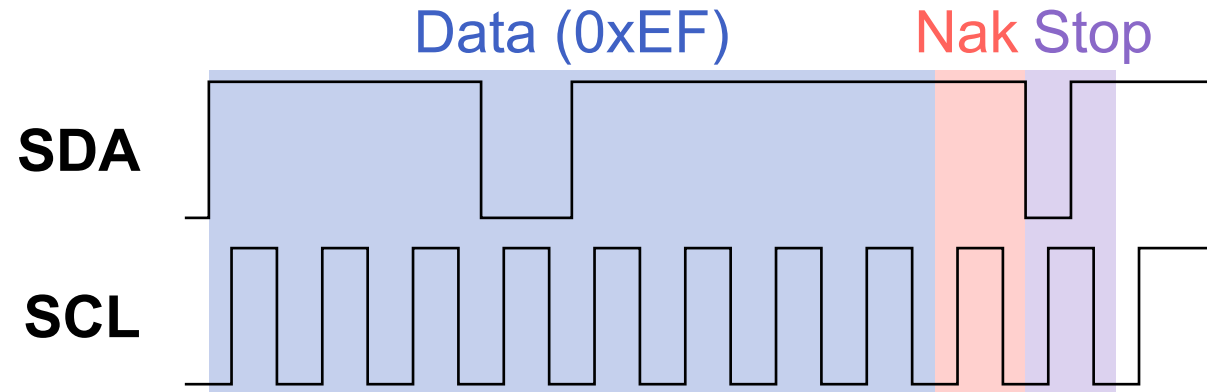
true

fmt_fifo

[Rd 3 {stop}]

rx_fifo

[0xBE, 0xEF]



OpenTitan I²C



enablehost

true

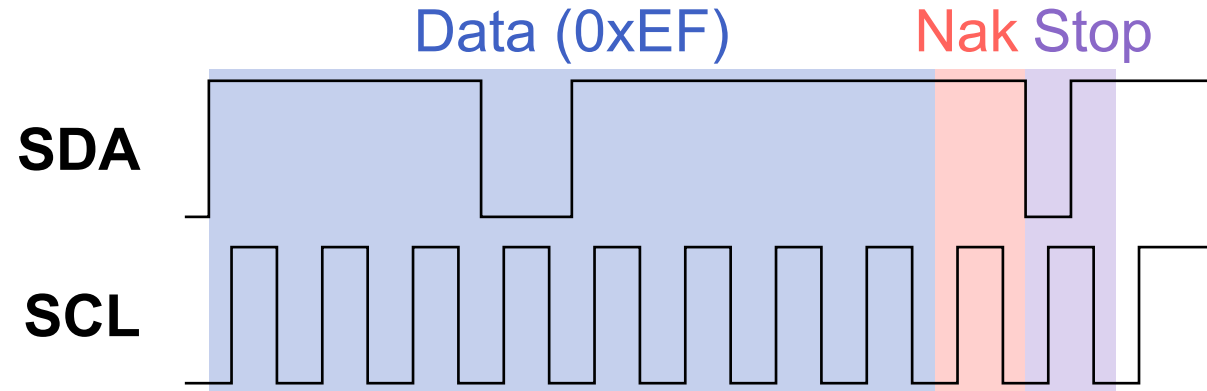
fmt_fifo

[]

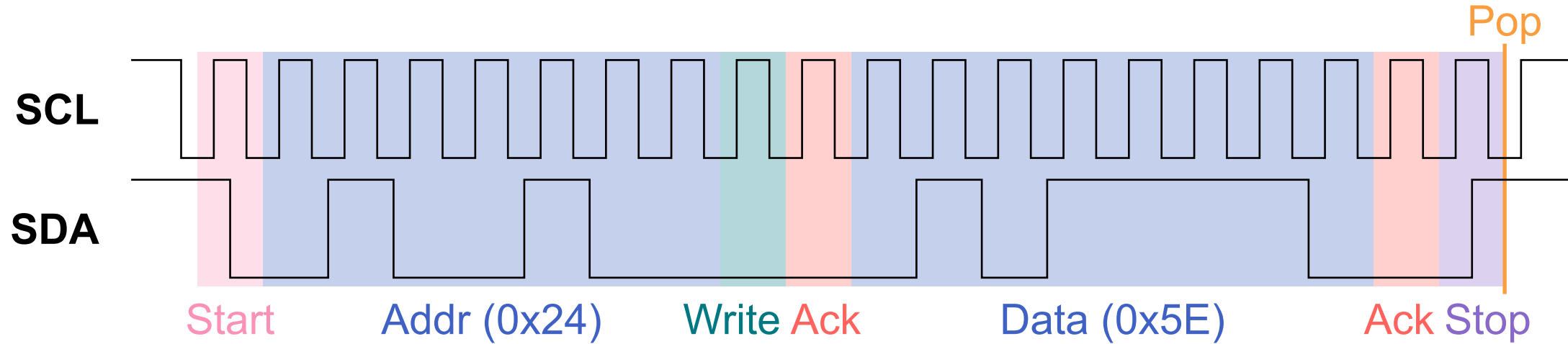
rx_fifo

[0xBE, 0xEF]

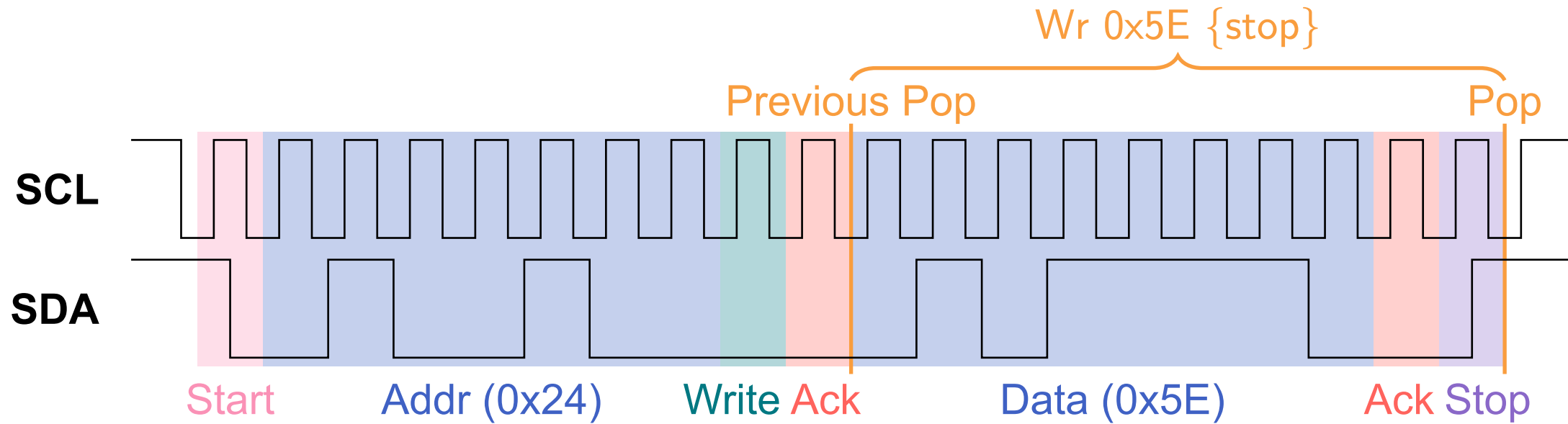
⚡ Interrupt!



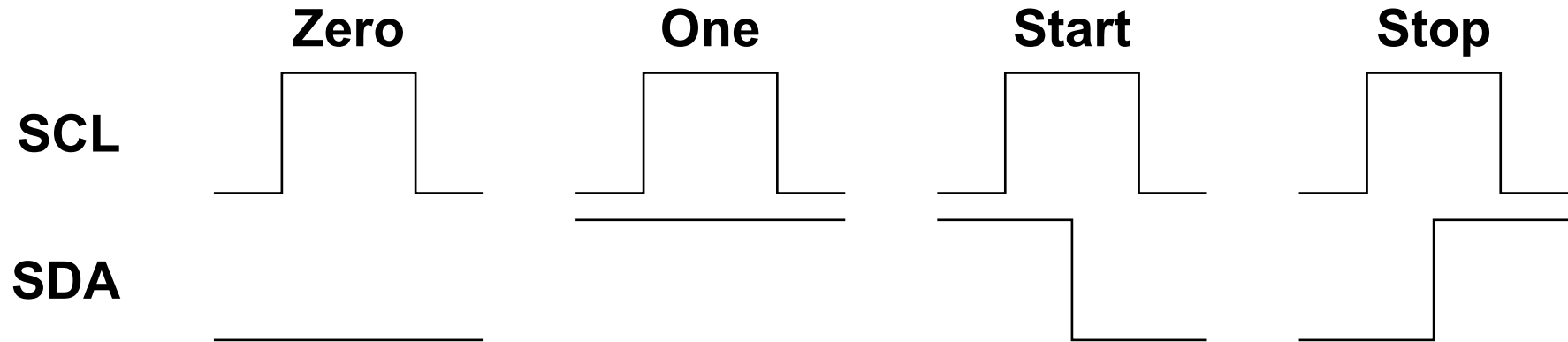
OpenTitan I²C



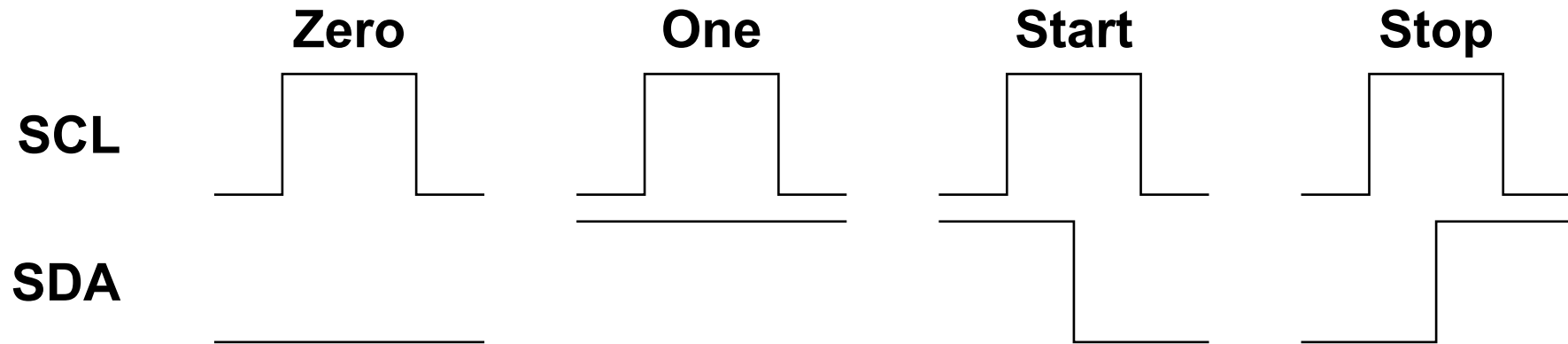
OpenTitan I²C



OpenTitan I²C

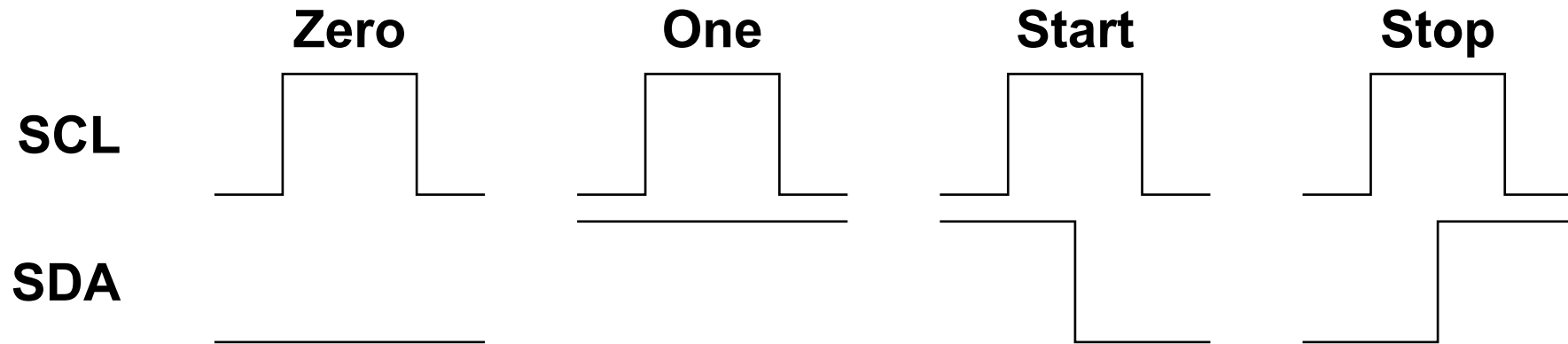


OpenTitan I²C



Wr 0x48 {start} → [Start, 0, 1, 0, 0, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0]

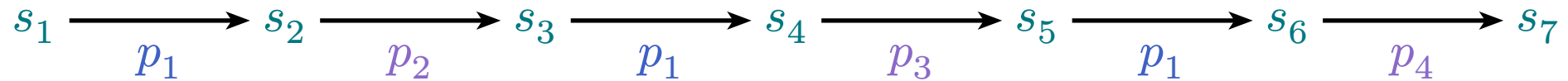
OpenTitan I²C



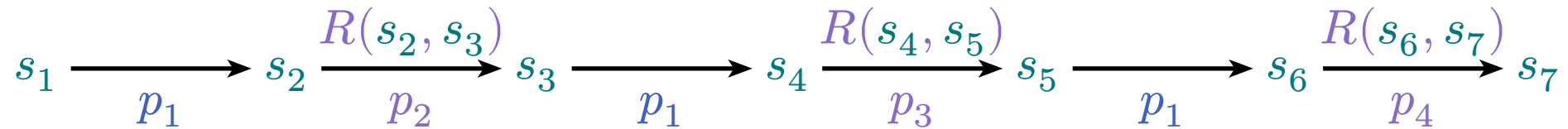
Wr 0x48 {start} → [Start, 0, 1, 0, 0, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0]

Rd 2 {stop} → [?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?, 0, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, 1, Stop]

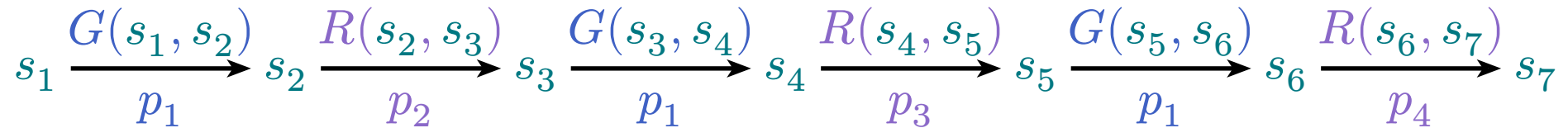
Rely-Guarantee



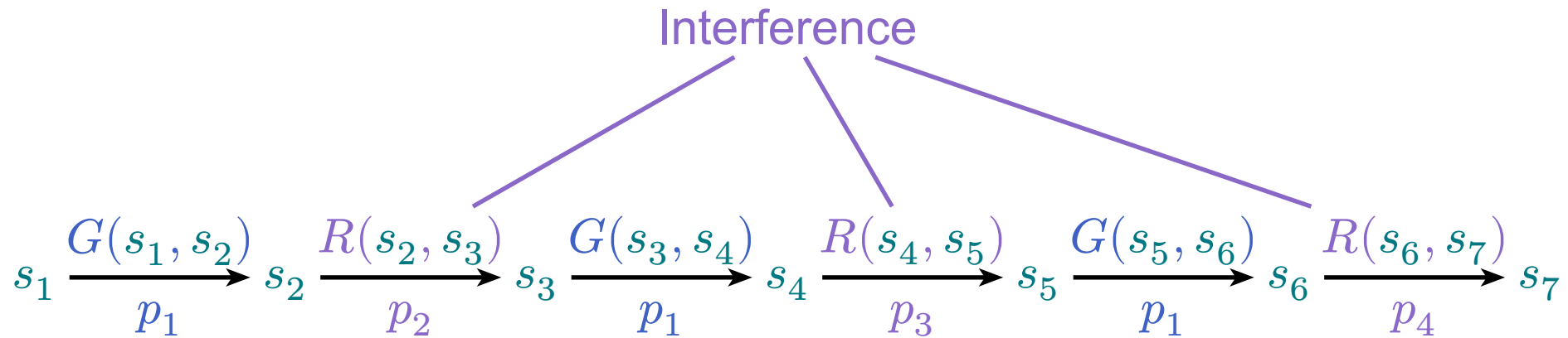
Rely-Guarantee



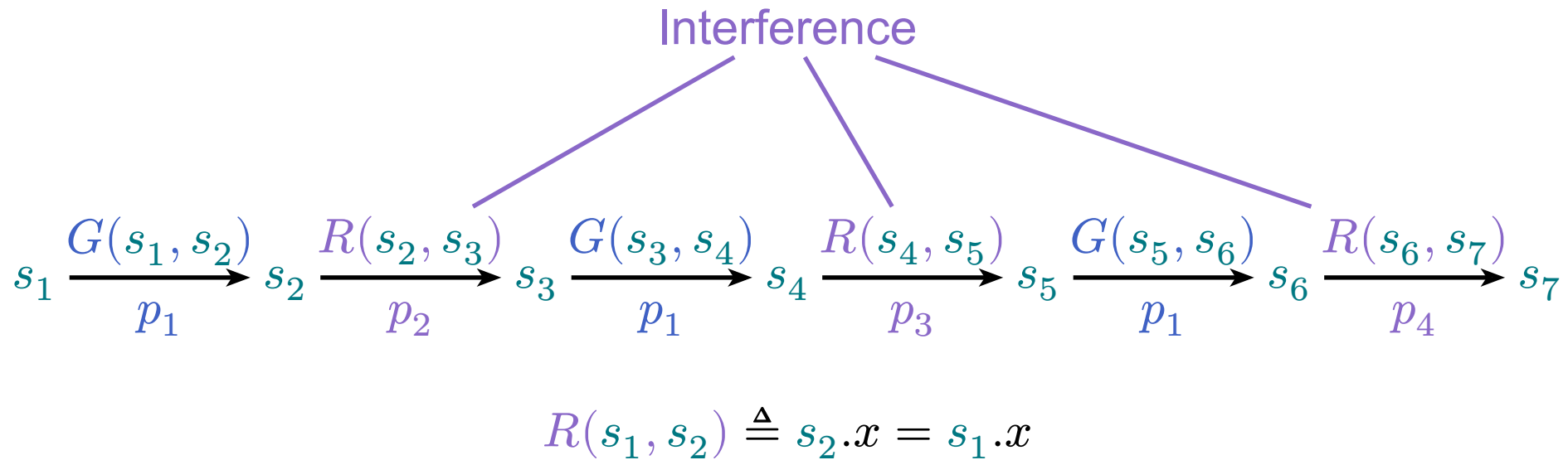
Rely-Guarantee



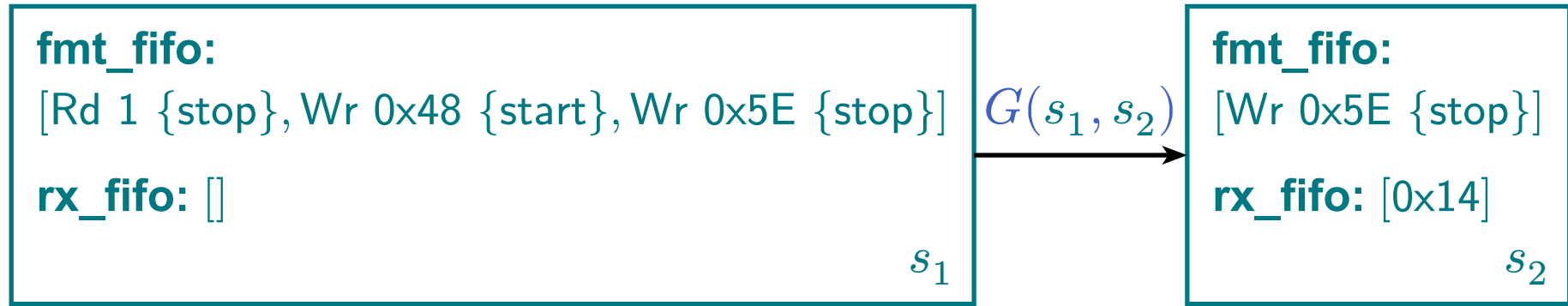
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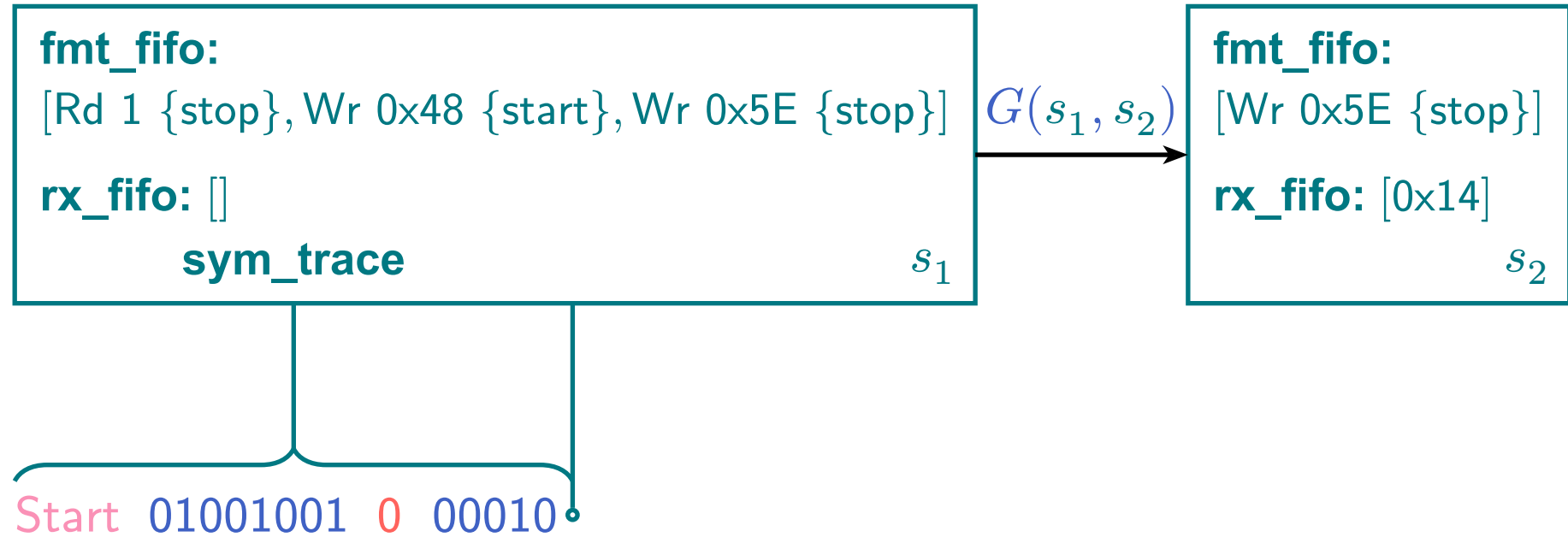
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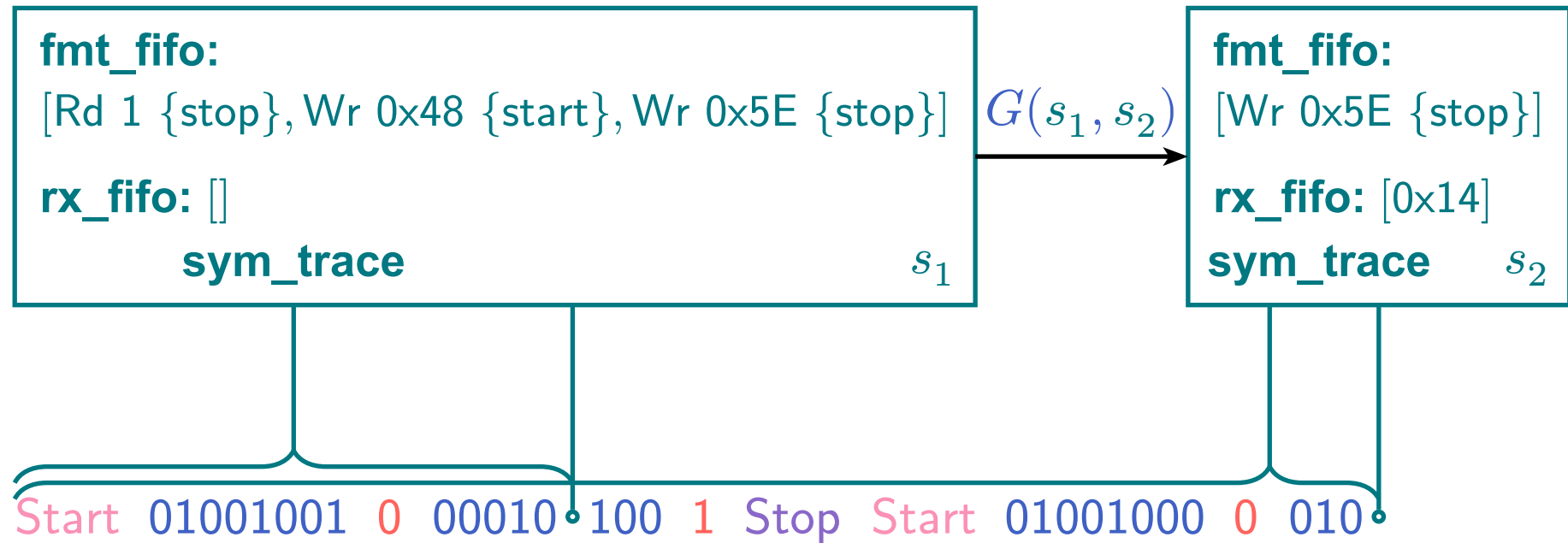
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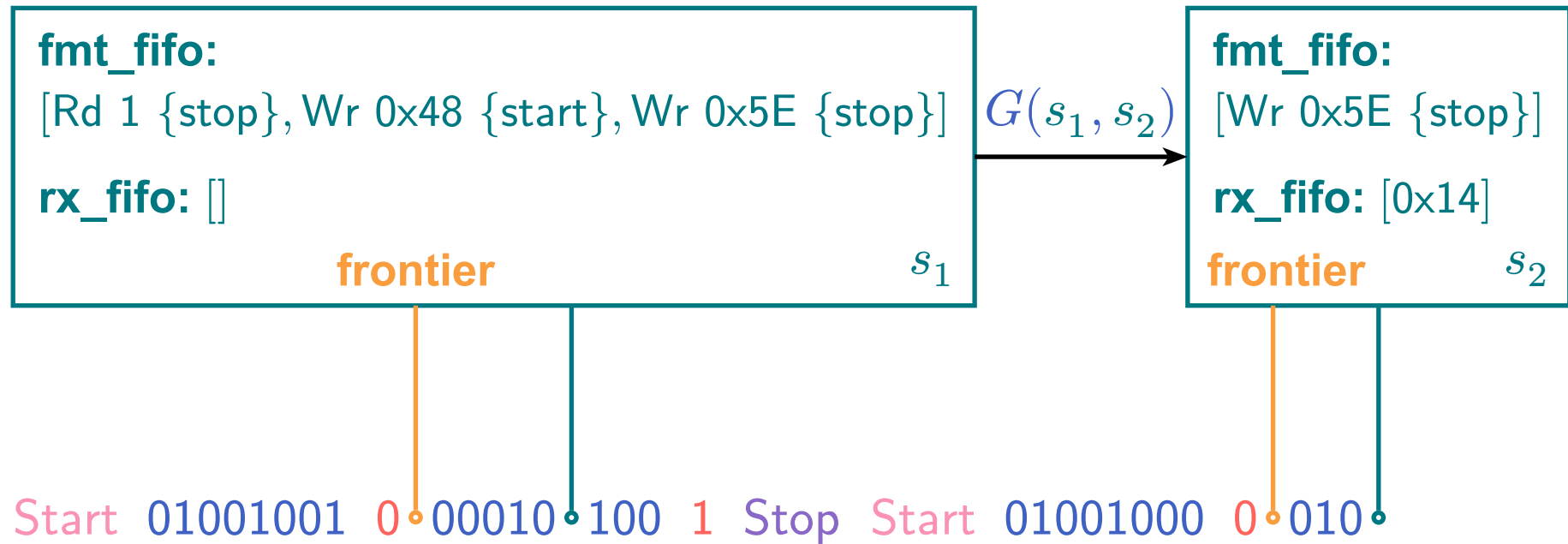
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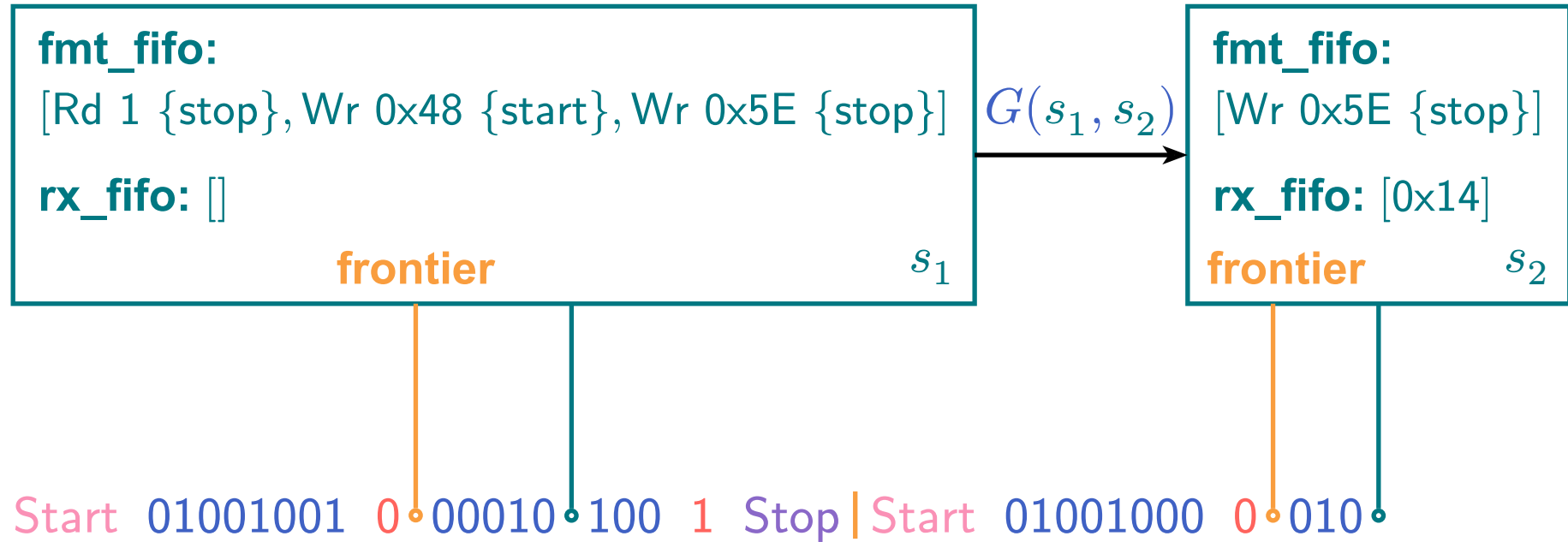
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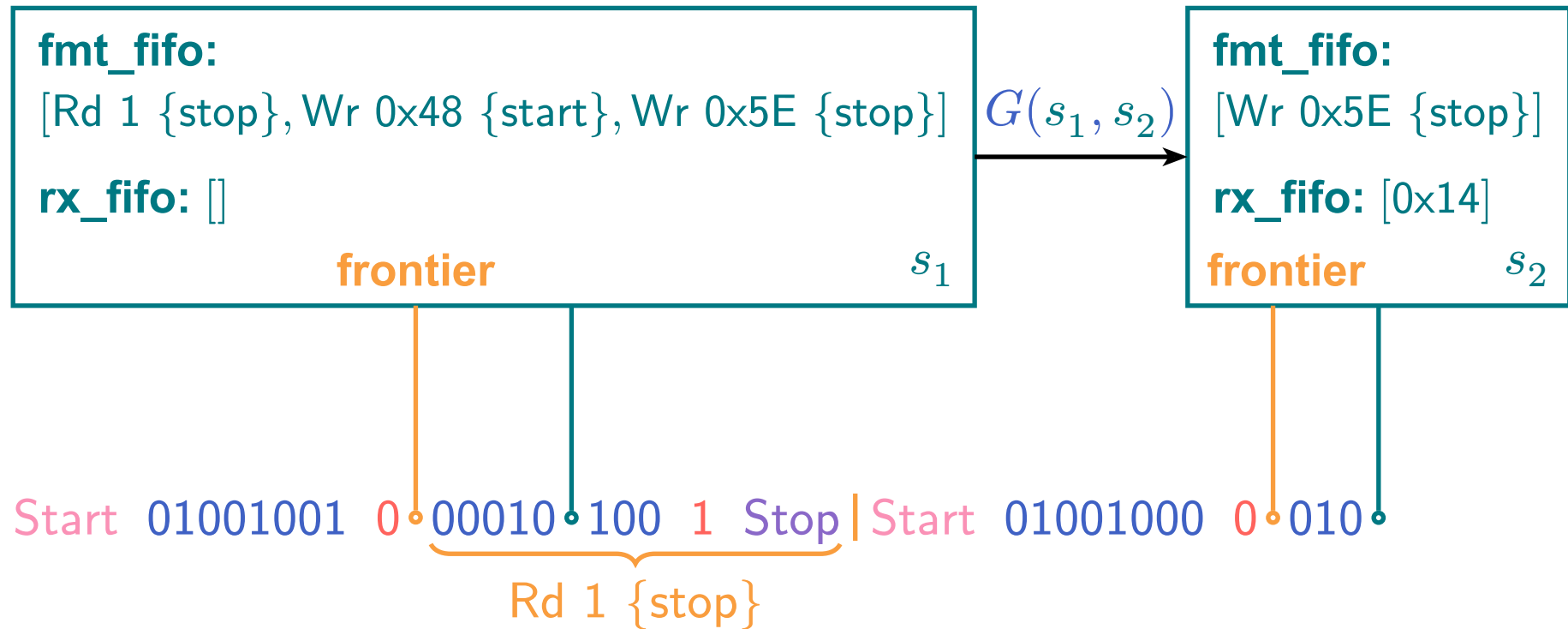
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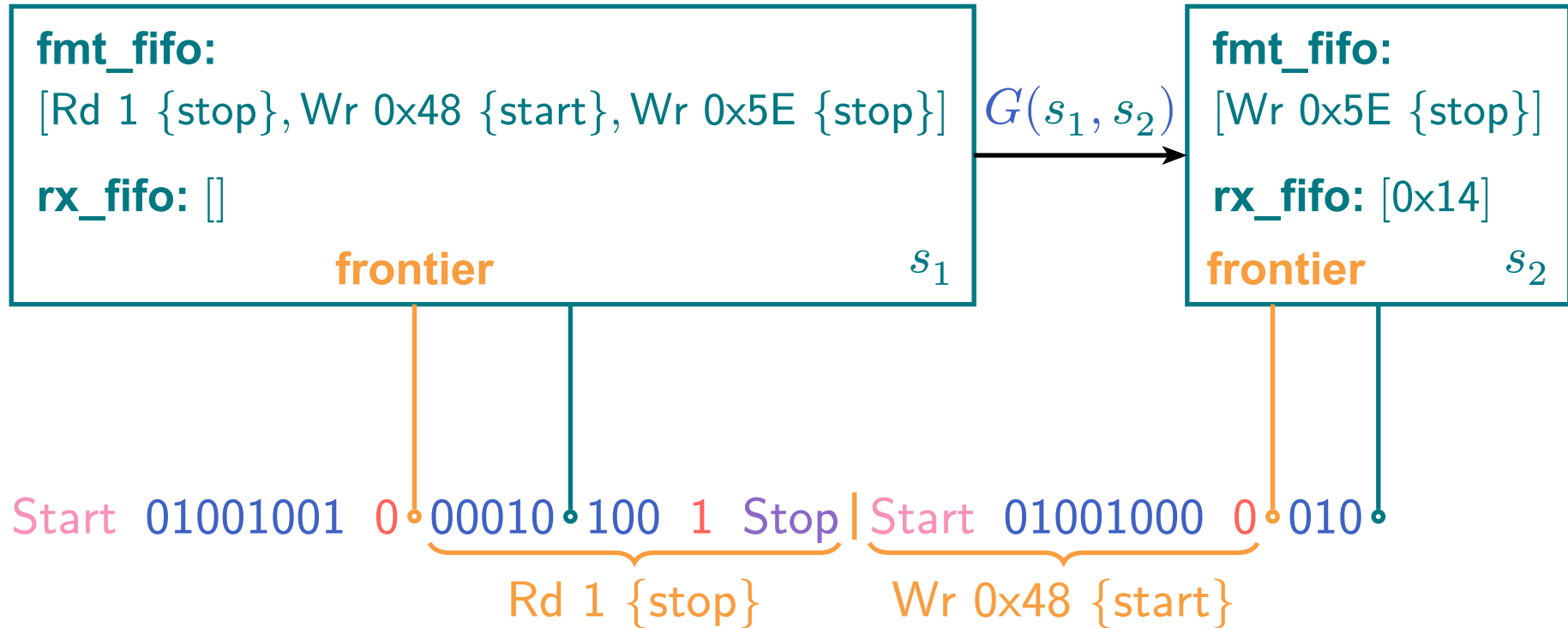
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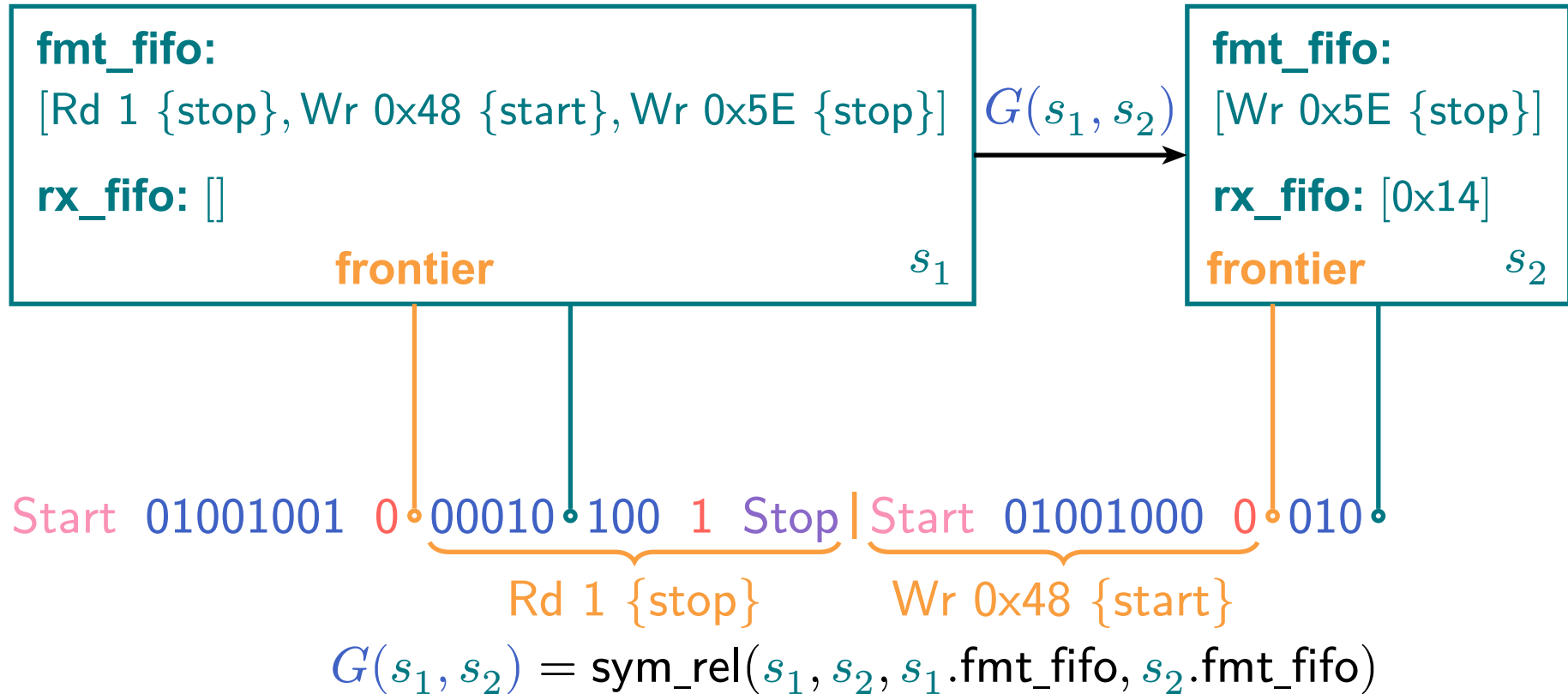
Rely-Guarantee



Rely-Guarantee



Rely-Guarantee



Rely-Guarantee



s_1 $\{|\text{fmt_fifo}| < 64\}$

$\text{FDATA} \leftarrow \text{cmd}$

s_2 $\{\text{fmt_fifo} = s_1.\text{fmt_fifo} + [\text{cmd}]\}$

Driver Verification

Pancake-to-Viper



```
fun 1 mul(1 x, 1 y) {  
  
  /@ requires y >= 0 @/  
  /@ ensures retval == x * y @/  
  var i = 0;  
  var res = 0;  
  while i < y {  
    /@ invariant i <= y @/  
    /@ invariant res == x * i @/  
    res = res + x;  
    /@ assert res == x * (i + 1) @/  
    i = i + 1;  
  }  
  return res;  
}
```

```
function mul(gv:Ref, x:Int, y:Int)  
  returns (retval: Int)  
  requires y >= 0  
  ensures retval == x * y  
{  
  var i: Int := 0;  
  var res: Int := 0;  
  while (i < y)  
    invariant i <= y && res == x*i  
  {  
    res := res + x;  
    assert res == x * (i + 1);  
    i := i + 1;  
  }  
  retval := res;  
}
```

Pancake-to-Viper



```
fun 1 mul(1 x, 1 y) {  
  
  /@ requires y >= 0 @/  
  /@ ensures retval == x * y @/  
  var i = 0;  
  var res = 0;  
  while i < y {  
    /@ invariant i <= y @/  
    /@ invariant res == x * i @/  
    res = res + x;  
    /@ assert res == x * (i + 1) @/  
    i = i + 1;  
  }  
  return res;  
}
```

```
function mul(gv:Ref, x:Int, y:Int)  
  returns (retval: Int)  
  requires y >= 0  
  ensures retval == x * y  
{ var i: Int := 0;  
  var res: Int := 0;  
  while (i < y)  
    invariant i <= y && res == x*i  
    {  
      res := res + x;  
      assert res == x * (i + 1);  
      i := i + 1;  
    }  
  retval := res;  
}
```

Pancake-to-Viper



```
fun 1 mul(1 x, 1 y) {  
  
  /@ requires y >= 0 @/  
  /@ ensures retval == x * y @/  
  var i = 0;  
  var res = 0;  
  while i < y {  
    /@ invariant i <= y @/  
    /@ invariant res == x * i @/  
    res = res + x;  
    /@ assert res == x * (i + 1) @/  
    i = i + 1;  
  }  
  return res;  
}
```

```
function mul(gv:Ref, x:Int, y:Int)  
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  var i: Int := 0;  
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  while (i < y)  
    invariant i <= y && res == x*i  
  {  
    res := res + x;  
    assert res == x * (i + 1);  
    i := i + 1;  
  }  
  retval := res;  
}
```

Pancake-to-Viper



```
/@ shared w u32 fdata[50343964] @/  
/@ shared r u32 rdata[50343960] @/  
!st32 50343964, x;  
!ld32 x, 50343960;
```

```
store_fdata(gv, 50343964, x);  
x := load_rdata(gv, 50343960);
```

Pancake-to-Viper



```
field enablehost: Bool
field fmt_fifo: Seq[FmtEntry]
field rx_fifo: Seq[Int]
field sym_trace: Seq[Sym]
field rx_frontier: Int
field sym_frontier: Int

method foo(gv: Ref, cmd: FmtEntry) {
  // Impossible from Pancake
  gv.fmt_fifo := gv.fmt_fifo ++ [cmd];
  // Possible from Pancake
  assert |gv.fmt_fifo| >= 1
}
```

Driver Verification



```
method store_fdata(gv: Ref, addr: Int, value: Int)
  requires |gv.fmt_fifo| < 64
  ensures gv.fmt_fifo == old(gv.fmt_fifo) ++ Seq(parse(value))
```

Driver Verification



```
fun 1 write_cmd(1 cmd) {  
  /@ requires |gv.fmt_fifo| < 64 @/  
  /@ ensures gv.fmt_fifo == old(gv.fmt_fifo) ++ [parse(cmd)] @/  
  
  !st32 FDATA, cmd;  
  
  var i = 0;  
  while i < 10000000 {  
    i = i + 1;  
  }  
  
  return 0;  
}
```

Driver Verification



$s_1 \quad \{ \quad ??? \quad \}$

interference

$s_2 \quad \{ |fmt_fifo| < 64 \}$

$FDATA \leftarrow cmd$

$s_3 \quad \{ fmt_fifo = s_2.fmt_fifo + [cmd] \}$

interference

$s_4 \quad \{ \quad ??? \quad \}$

Driver Verification



s_1 { ??? } ————— new precondition

interference

s_2 { |fmt_fifo| < 64 }

FDATA $\leftarrow$ cmd

s_3 { fmt_fifo = s_2 .fmt_fifo + [cmd] }

interference

s_4 { ??? }

Driver Verification



s_1 { ??? } ————— new precondition

interference

s_2 { |fmt_fifo| < 64 } ————— old precondition

FDATA $\leftarrow$ cmd

s_3 { fmt_fifo = s_2 .fmt_fifo + [cmd] } — old postcondition

interference

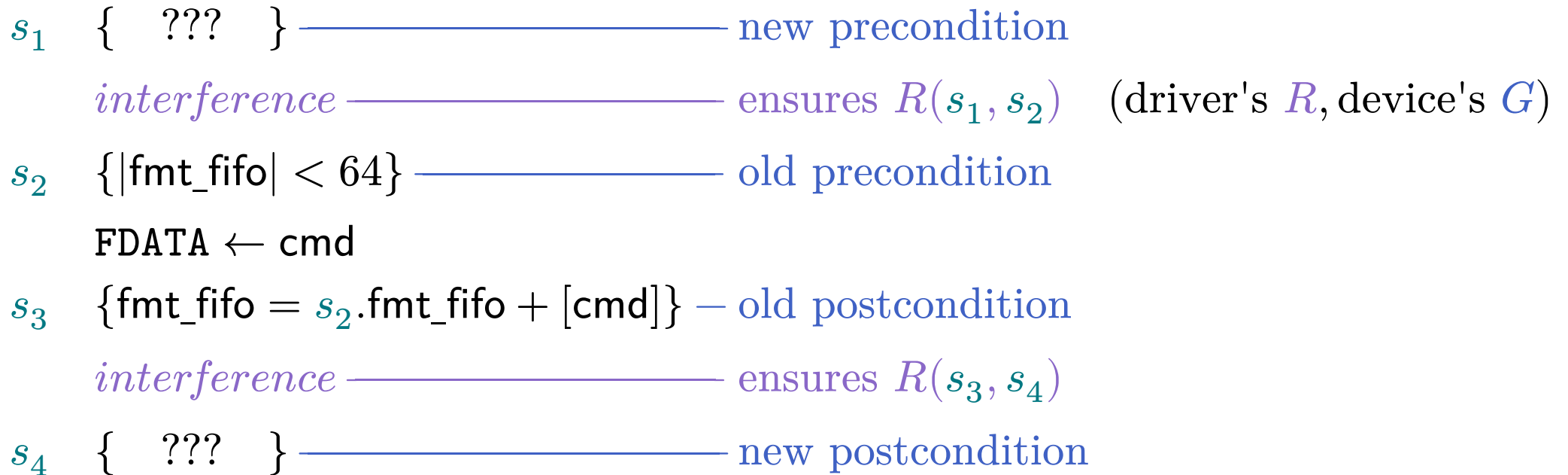
s_4 { ??? }

Driver Verification



- s_1 { ??? } ————— new precondition
interference
- s_2 { |fmt_fifo| < 64 } ————— old precondition
FDATA $\leftarrow$ cmd
- s_3 { fmt_fifo = s_2 .fmt_fifo + [cmd] } — old postcondition
interference
- s_4 { ??? } ————— new postcondition

Driver Verification



Driver Verification



s_1 { ??? }

interference — new precondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \implies$ old precondition

s_2 { |fmt_fifo| < 64 }

FDATA $\leftarrow$ cmd

s_3 { fmt_fifo = s_2 .fmt_fifo + [cmd] }

interference

s_4 { ??? }

Driver Verification



s_1 { ??? }

interference – new precondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \Rightarrow$ old precondition

s_2 { |fmt_fifo| < 64 }

FDATA $\leftarrow$ cmd

s_3 { fmt_fifo = s_2 .fmt_fifo + [cmd] }

interference – old postcondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \wedge R(s_3, s_4) \Rightarrow$ new postcondition

s_4 { ??? }

Driver Verification



$s_1 \quad \{|fmt_fifo| < 64\}$

interference — new precondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \implies$ old precondition

$s_2 \quad \{|fmt_fifo| < 64\}$

$FDATA \leftarrow cmd$

$s_3 \quad \{fmt_fifo = s_2.fmt_fifo + [cmd]\}$

interference — old postcondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \wedge R(s_3, s_4) \implies$ new postcondition

$s_4 \quad \{ \quad ??? \quad \}$

Driver Verification



$s_1 \quad \{|fmt_fifo| < 64\}$

interference — new precondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \implies$ old precondition

$s_2 \quad \{|fmt_fifo| < 64\}$

$FDATA \leftarrow cmd$

$s_3 \quad \{fmt_fifo = s_2.fmt_fifo + [cmd]\}$

interference — old postcondition $\wedge R(s_1, s_2) \wedge R(s_3, s_4) \implies$ new postcondition

$s_4 \quad \{sym_rel(s_1, s_4, s_1.fmt_fifo + [cmd], s_4.fmt_fifo)\}$

Driver Verification



$s_1 \quad \{|\text{fmt_fifo}| < 64\}$

$\text{FDATA} \leftarrow \text{cmd}$

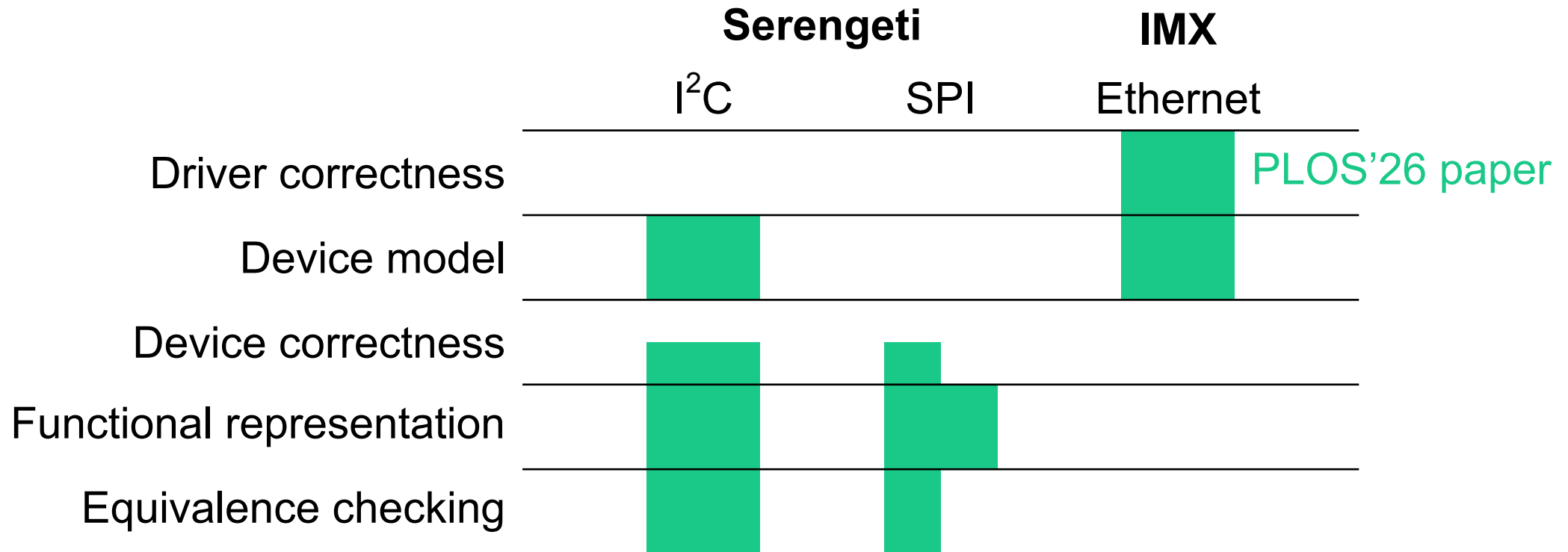
$s_2 \quad \{\text{sym_rel}(s_1, s_2, s_1.\text{fmt_fifo} + [\text{cmd}], s_2.\text{fmt_fifo})\}$

Status



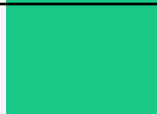
	Serengeti		IMX
	I ² C	SPI	Ethernet
Driver correctness			
Device model			
Device correctness			
Functional representation			
Equivalence checking			

Status

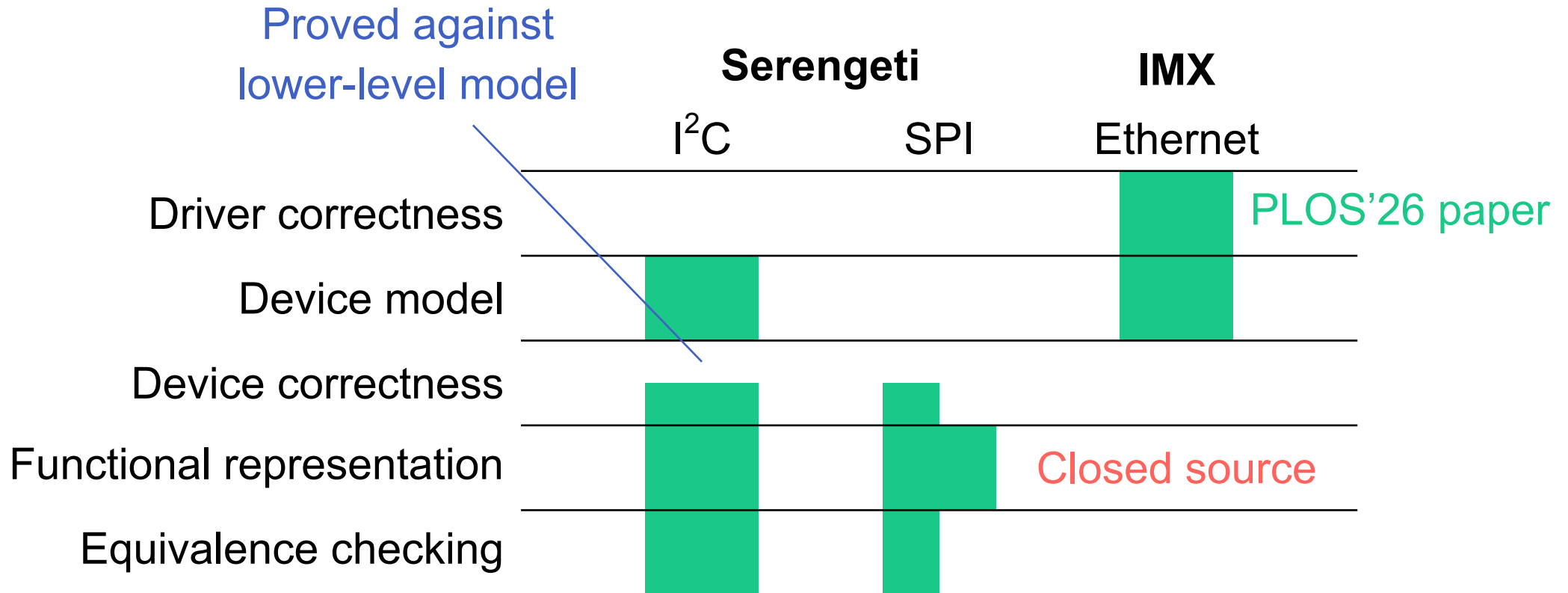


Status

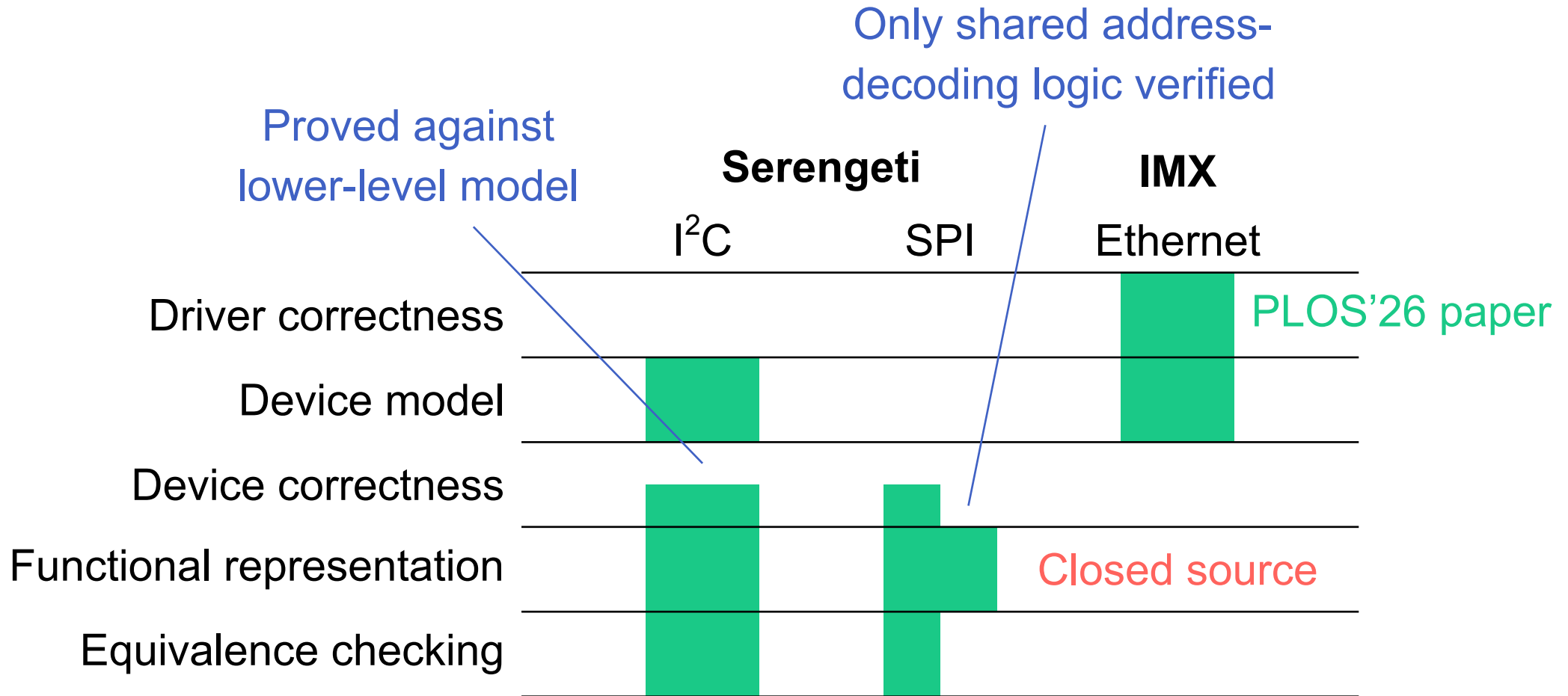


	Serengeti		IMX	
	I ² C	SPI	Ethernet	
Driver correctness				PLOS'26 paper
Device model				
Device correctness				Closed source
Functional representation				
Equivalence checking				

Status



Status



Future Work



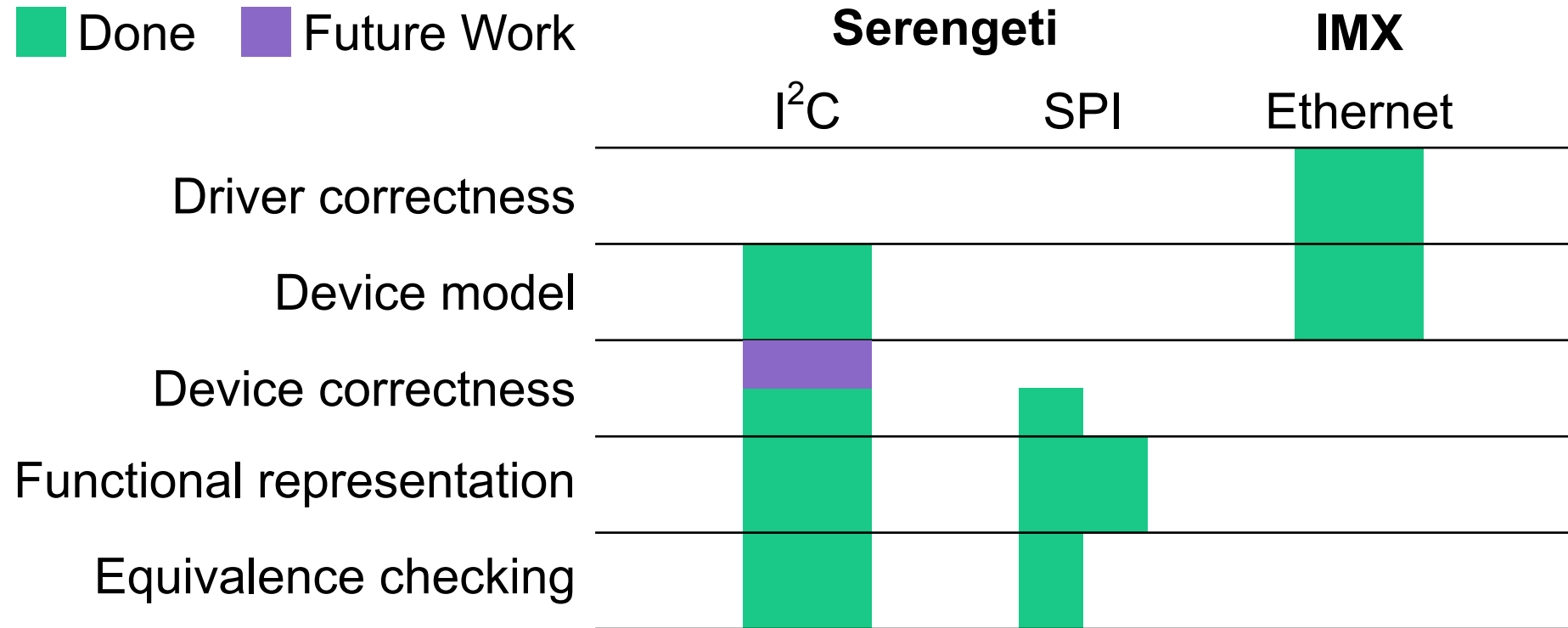
■ Done ■ Future Work

	Serengeti		IMX
	I ² C	SPI	Ethernet
Driver correctness			Done
Device model	Done		Done
Device correctness	Done	Done	
Functional representation	Done	Done	
Equivalence checking	Done	Done	

Future Work



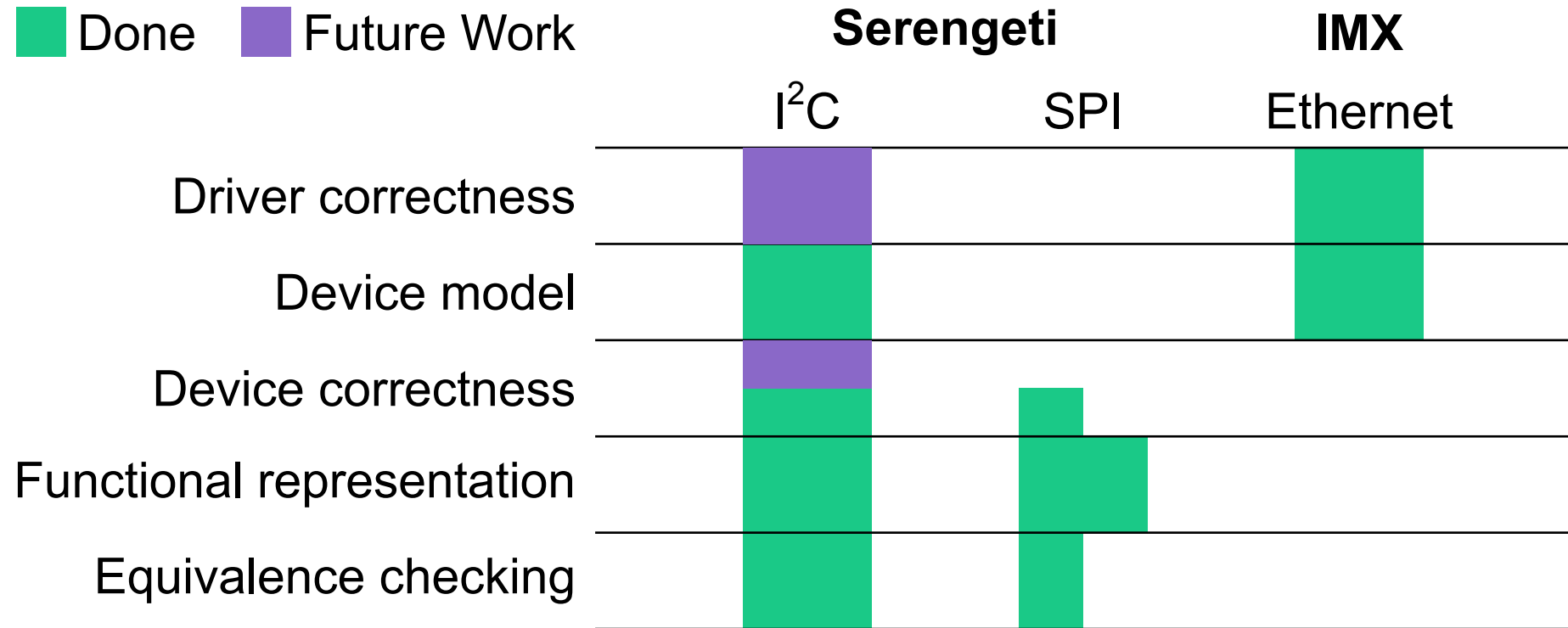
■ Done ■ Future Work



Future Work



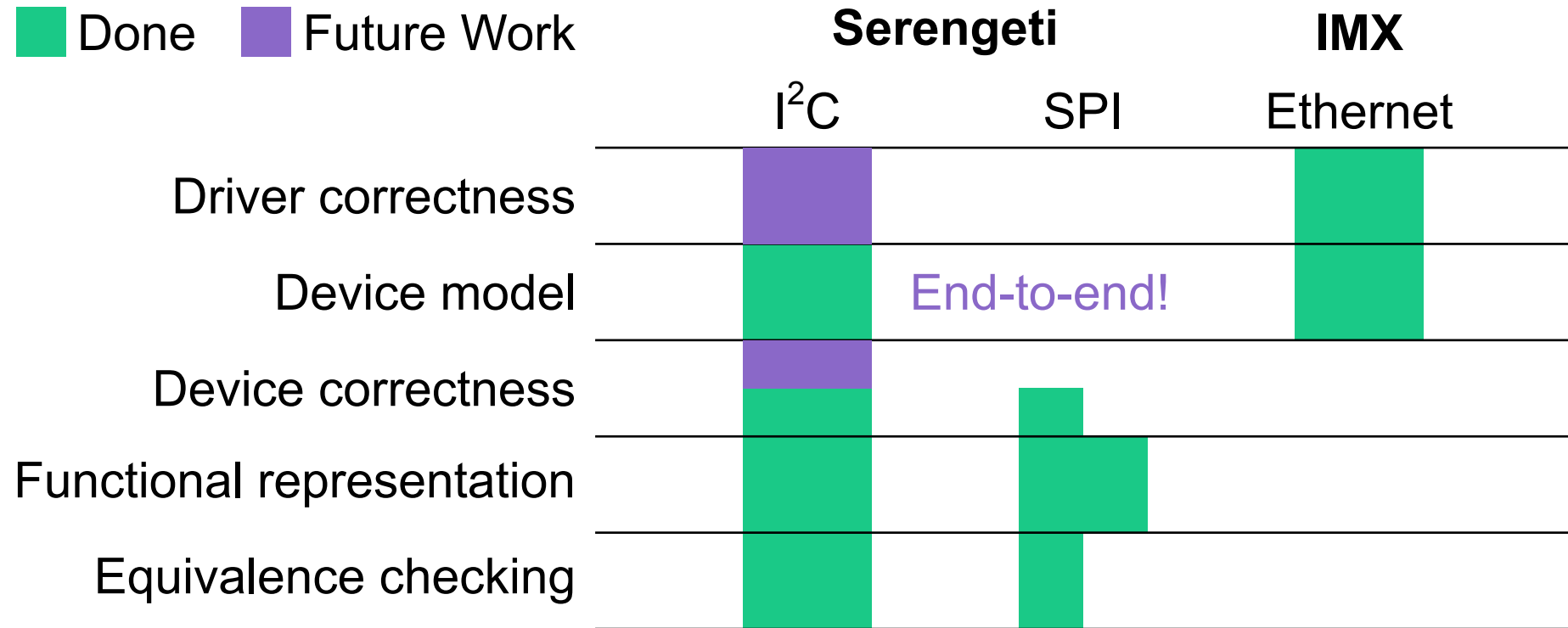
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Future Work



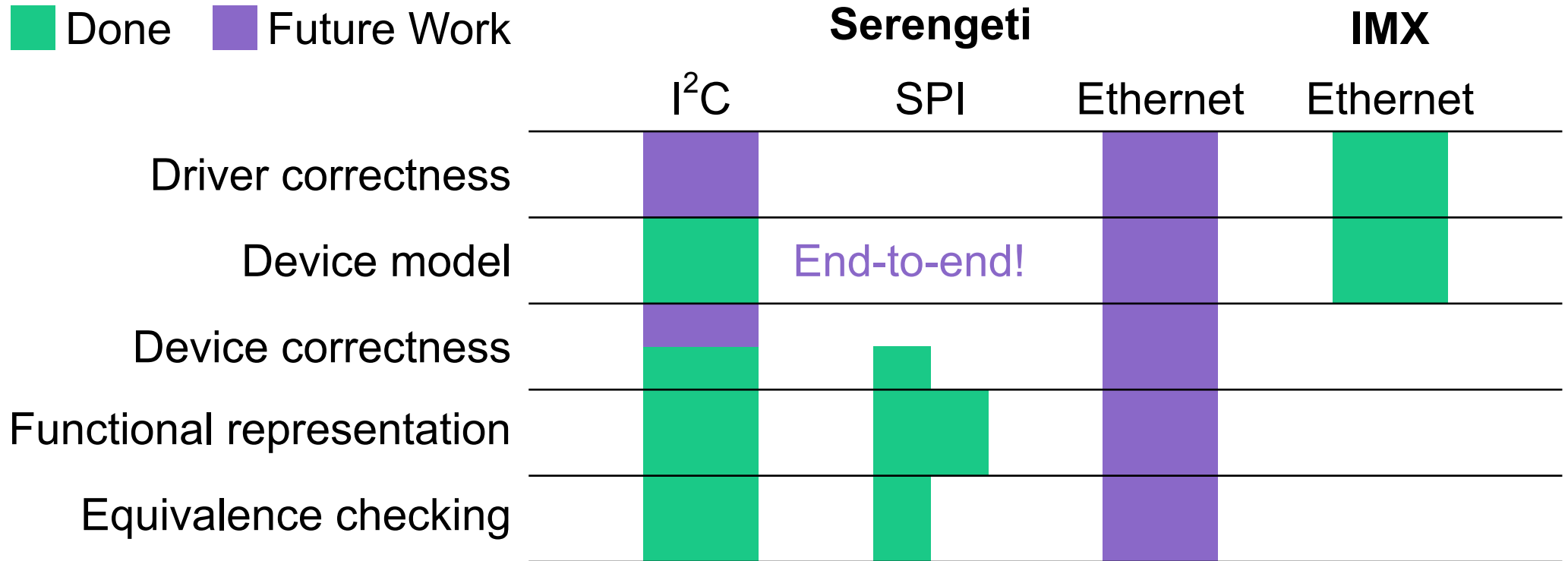
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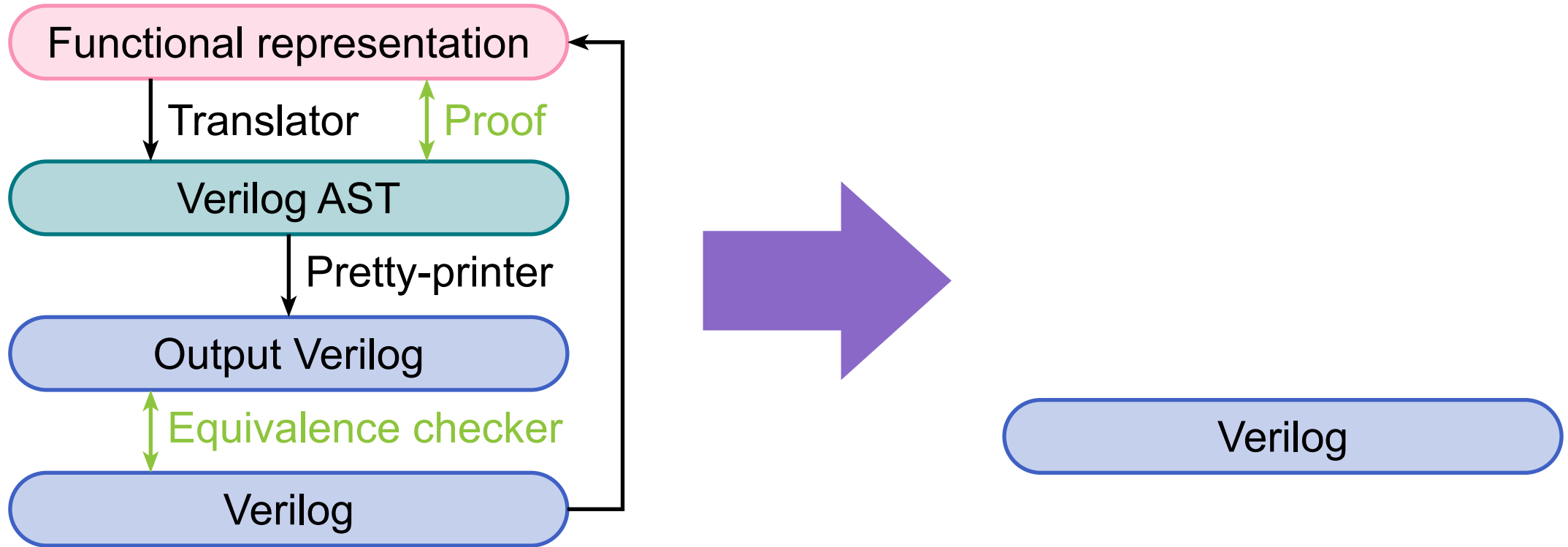
Future Work



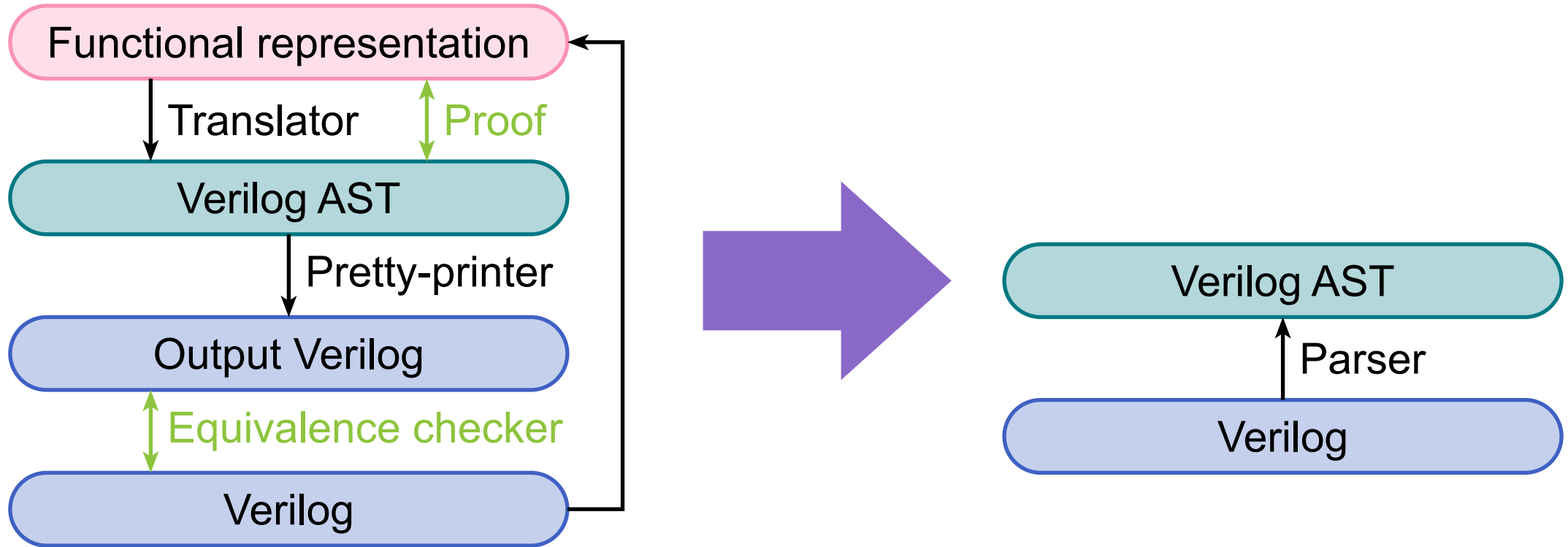
■ Done ■ Future Work



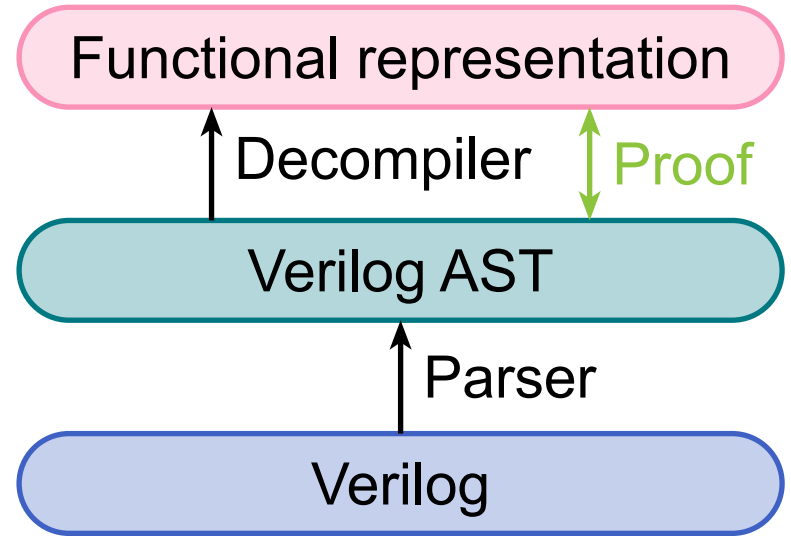
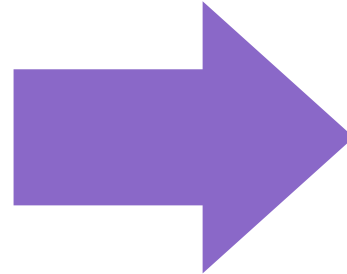
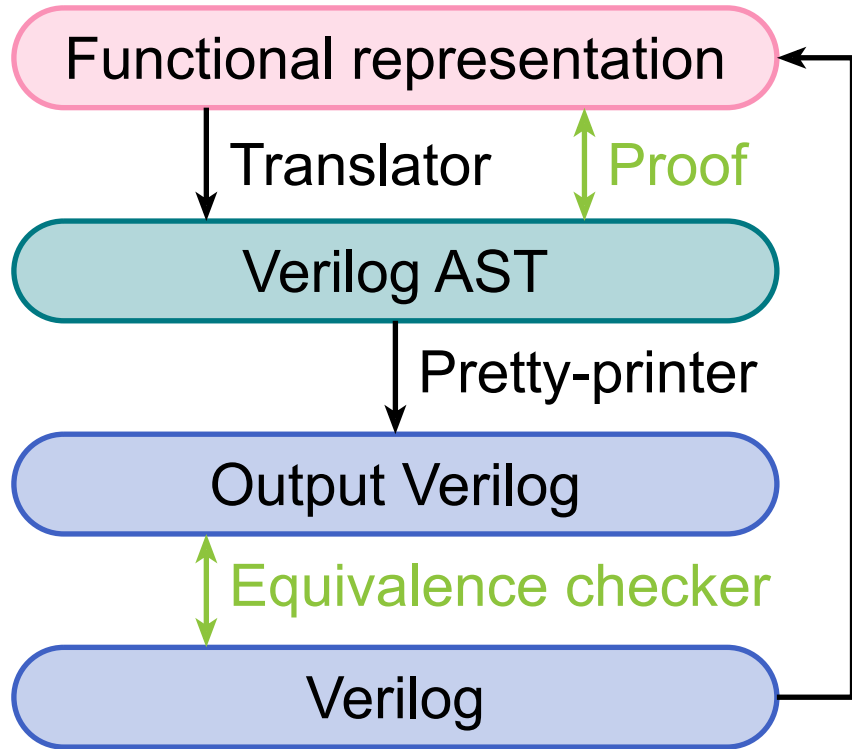
Future Work



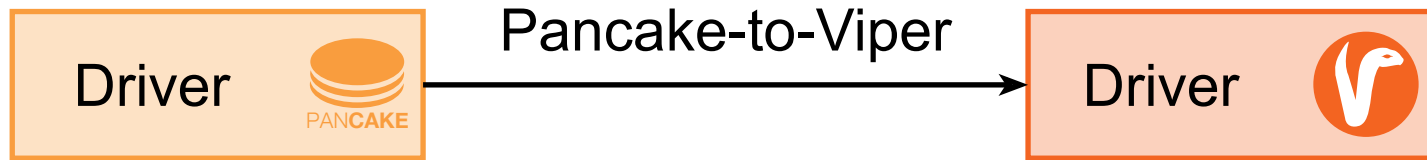
Future Work



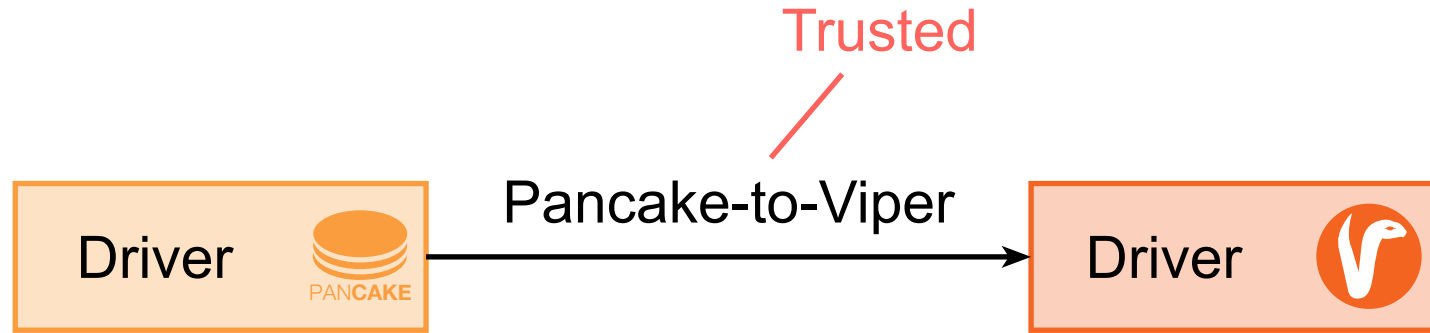
Future Work



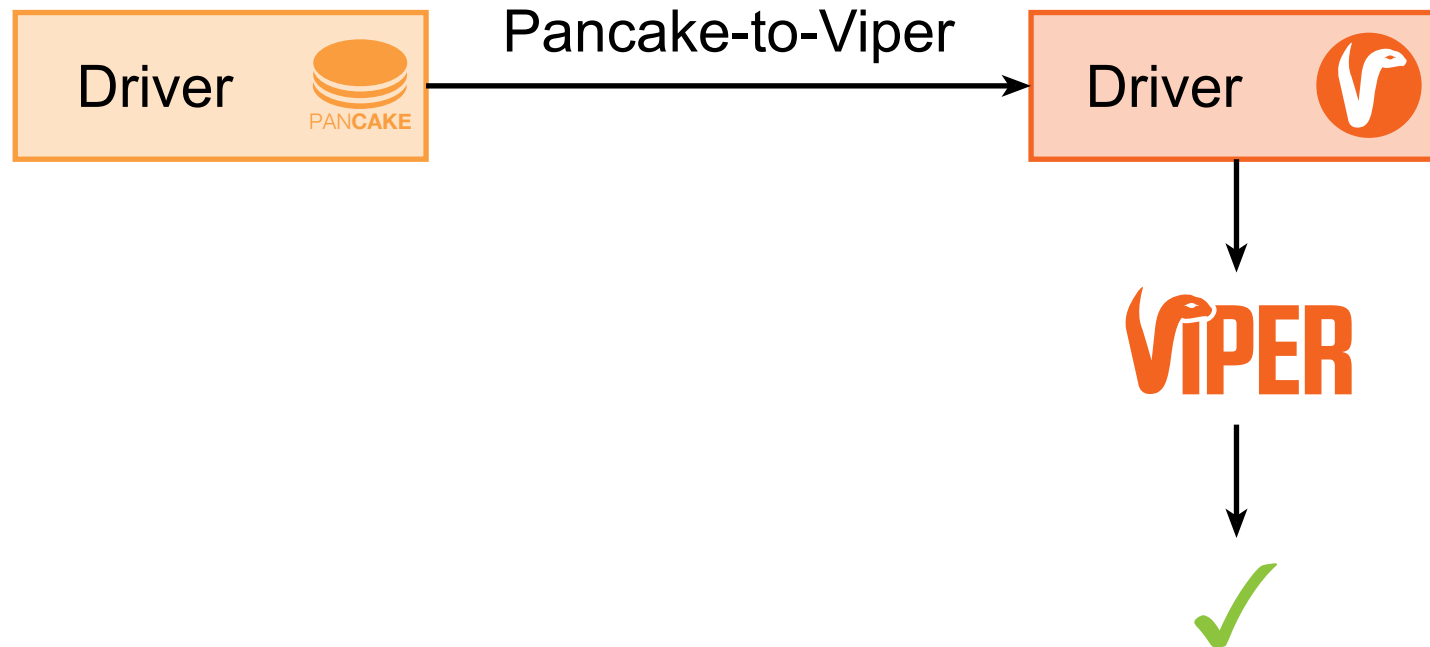
Future Work



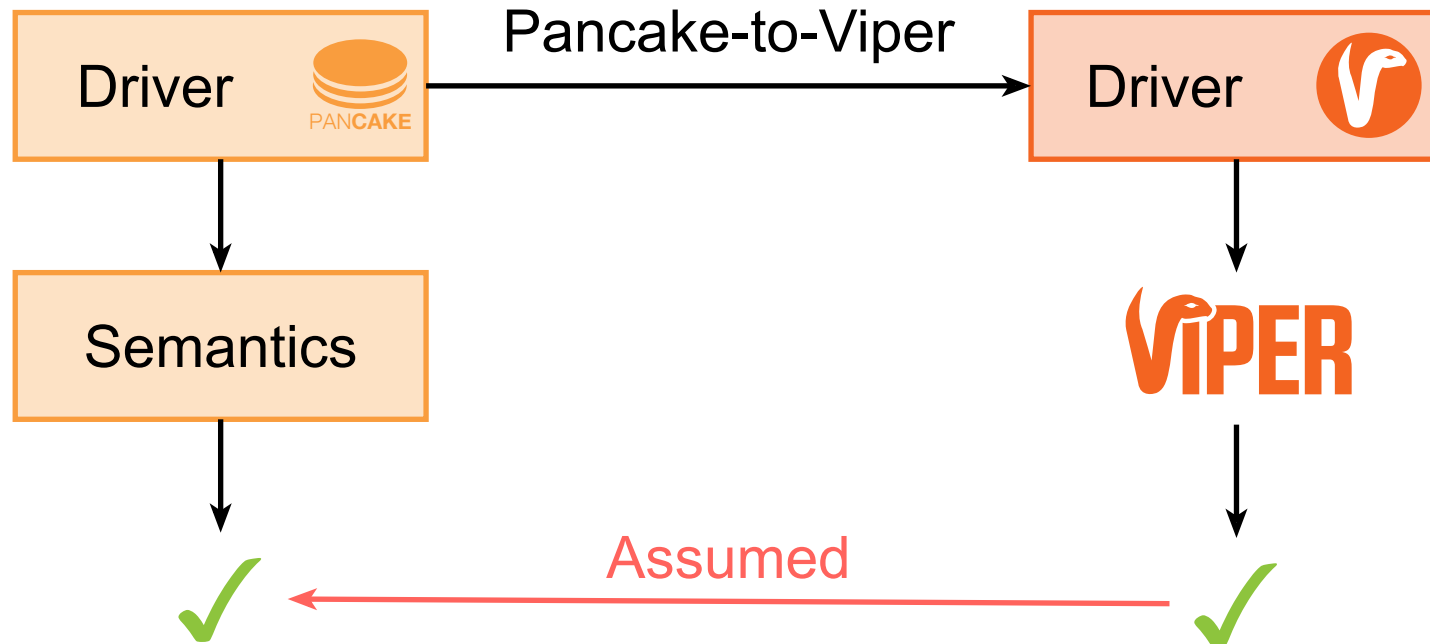
Future Work



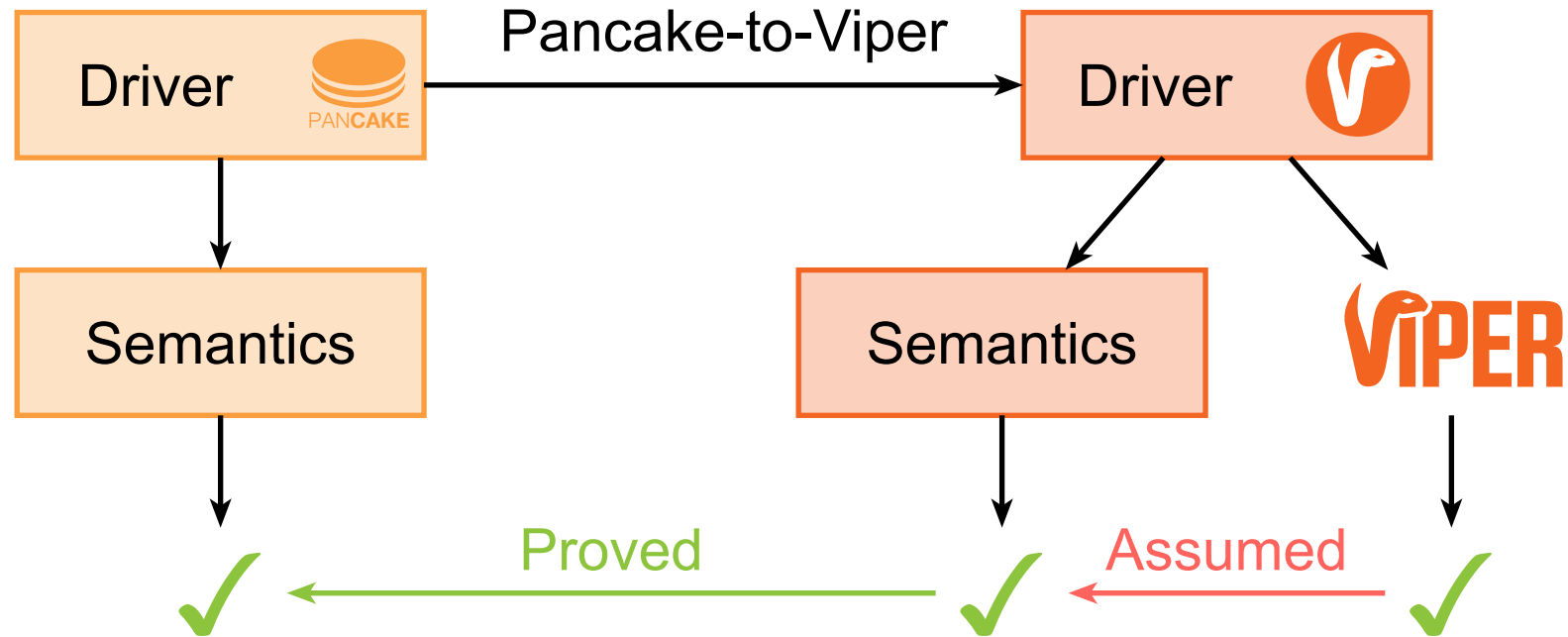
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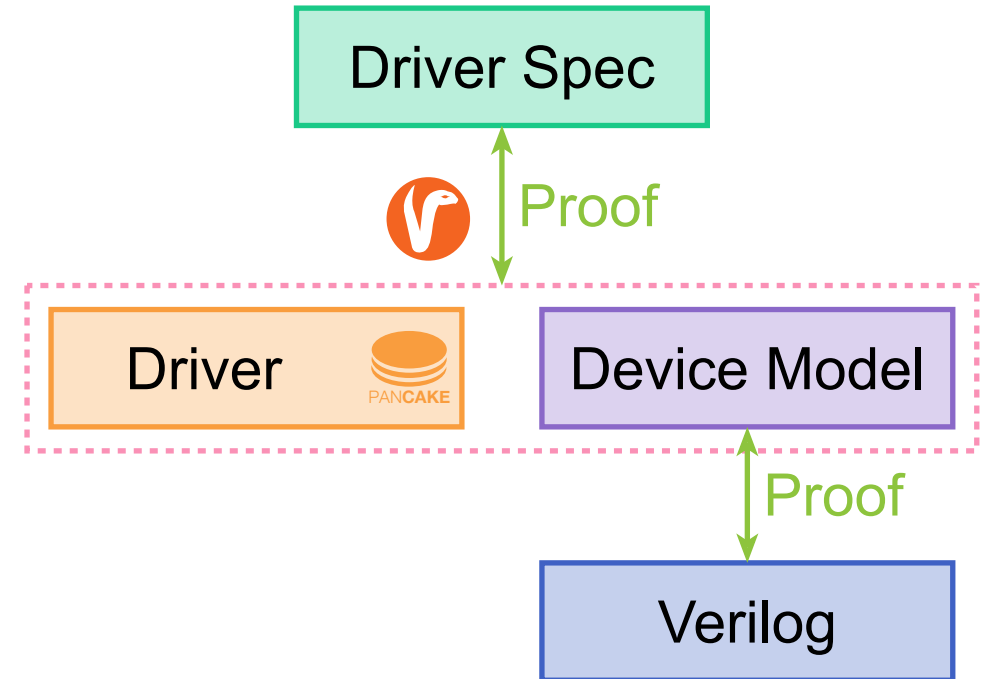
Future Work



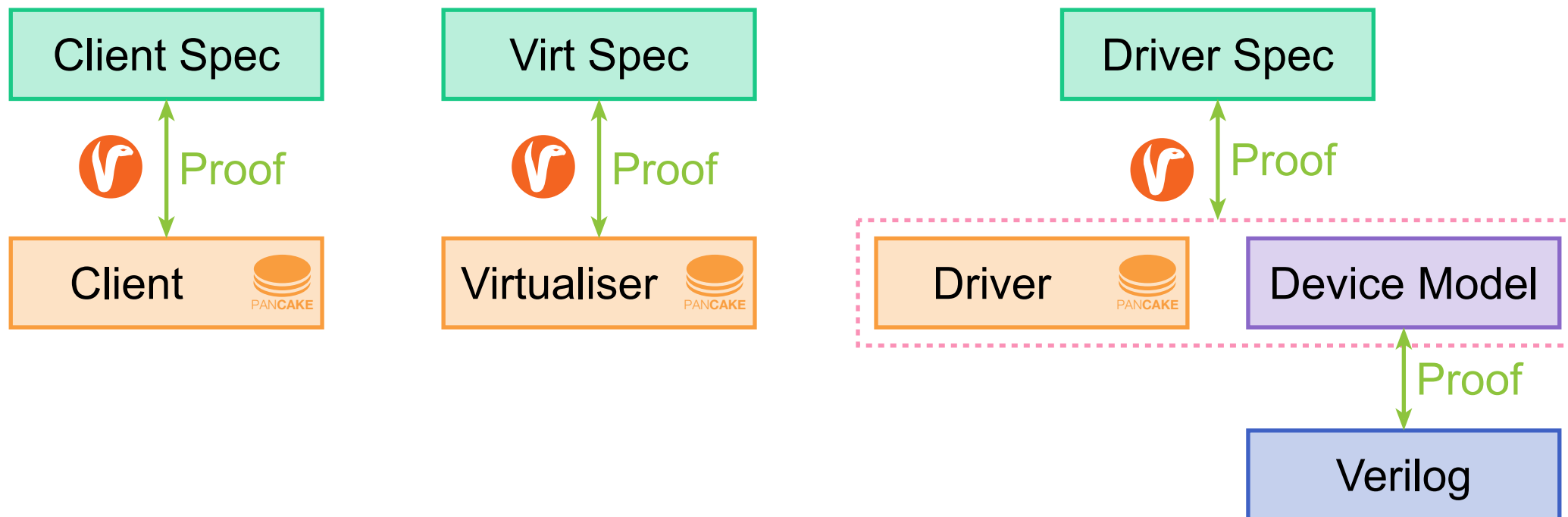
Future Work



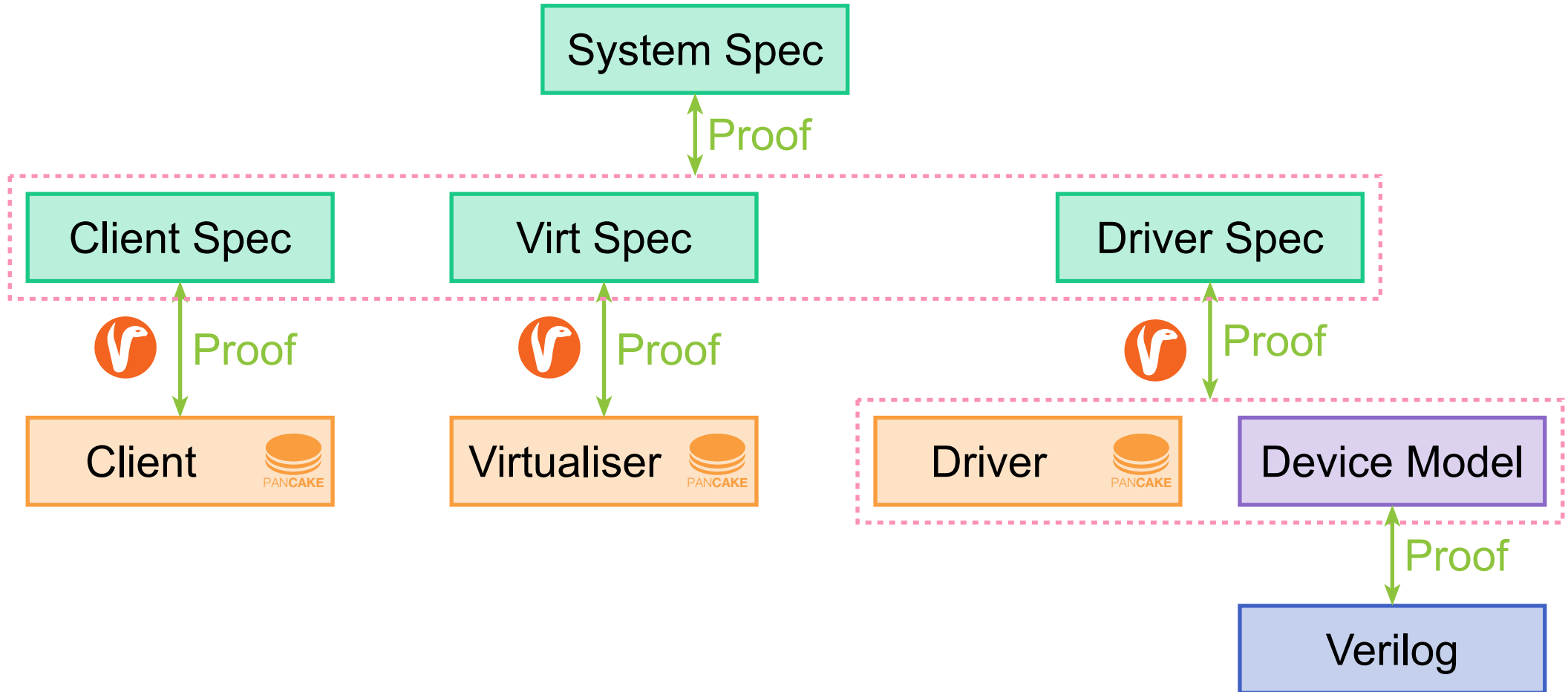
Future Work



Future Work



Future Work



Questions?

